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MCD math tilts towards BJP



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Admin reform: Ram Mandir Trust eyes corporate-style management



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Young people miss the solidity of older love: Imtiaz Ali

OFFERING PURE PETROL, E10 UNVIABLE

‘E20 may cut mileage by up to 5%, but is cleaner, scientifically tested’

Centre says performance and environmental gains outweigh lower fuel economy

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Friday defended the nationwide rollout of petrol blended with 20 per cent ethanol, saying the fuel may reduce mileage by 3 to 5 per cent in some vehicles but offers wider gains in engine performance, cleaner emissions, energy security and support for farmers. Releasing a detailed set of Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs), the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas sought to address growing public criticism over E20 fuel, including concerns about lower fuel economy, possible engine damage in older vehicles and the lack of an option to buy pure petrol or lower ethanol blends at fuel stations. The ministry said the programme was introduced after more than two decades of



planning, scientific testing and consultations with automobile manufacturers, and urged consumers not to be influenced by

HIGHLIGHTS

- » India reached 20% blending in 2025
- » Government says rollout was scientifically tested
- » E20 offers higher octane, cleaner combustion
- » No evidence of E20-related engine damage
- » Centre rejects multiple petrol-grade demand
- » Programme saves crude imports, forex
- » Farmers gained over Rs 1.66 lakh crore
- » Consumers urged to ignore misinformation

“misinformation” circulating on social media.

The government described the Ethanol Blended Petrol (EBP) Programme as a key part of India’s energy strategy, aimed at reducing dependence on imported crude oil, improving energy security, supporting the farming sector and cutting carbon emissions through greater use of domestically produced renewable fuel.

India achieved the milestone of 20 per cent ethanol blending in April 2025, five years ahead of its original 2030 target. The ministry said the country reached the target during the 2025-26 ethanol supply year after expanding domestic ethanol production and investing in dedicated ethanol plants, storage facilities and logistics infrastructure.

Rejecting criticism that the transition to E20 was rushed, the ministry **Continued on P4**

AMID STRAIT OF HORMUZ TENSIONS

Trump says US accepts Iran’s request for more talks, but ceasefire has ended

MPOST BUREAU

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump said on Friday that Washington had agreed to continue talks with Iran after receiving a request from Tehran, even as he declared that the June ceasefire between the two countries was “over”. His remarks came amid the biggest escalation since the June memorandum of understanding, with both sides exchanging attacks over shipping in the Strait of Hormuz, raising concerns over regional stability and global energy supplies.

In a post on Truth Social, Trump wrote, “The Islamic Republic of Iran has asked us to continue ‘talks’. We have agreed to do so, but the United States has stated to them, in no uncertain terms, that the Cease Fire is OVER!”

Iran did not immediately confirm Trump’s claim that it

TAKEAWAYS

- » Iran has not confirmed requesting fresh talks with Washington.
- » Fighting has intensified over navigation through the Strait of Hormuz.
- » Three Qatari and Saudi

commercial tankers came under fire this week.

» US struck Iranian sites after tanker attacks, prompting Iranian retaliation.

» Iran targeted US military installations in neighbouring Gulf states.

had sought further negotiations. Washington and Tehran have repeatedly offered differing accounts of their contacts throughout the conflict, which began on February 28.

The latest exchange of fire followed attacks this week involving commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz. Three Qatari and Saudi commercial tankers came under fire, prompting US strikes on Iranian sites and retaliatory Iranian attacks on US military installations in neighbouring Gulf states on Thursday. No

new attacks were reported on Friday.

According to US Central Command, American forces have struck about 170 targets in Iran since Tuesday, while Iran has targeted US assets across the region.

The June 17 memorandum of understanding had called for an immediate halt to fighting, the lifting of the US naval blockade on Iran and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz. However, both countries have accused each other **Continued on P4**

FIRST INDIAN PM TO VISIT NZ IN 40 YEARS

PM Modi’s New Zealand visit aims to boost trade, defence, education ties



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, accompanied by New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon, receives a ceremonial Guard of Honour upon his arrival in Auckland during his last leg of this three-nation visit

MPOST BUREAU

AUCKLAND: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday arrived in New Zealand on the final leg of his three-nation visit, during which he will hold talks with his counterpart Christopher Luxon and address the Indian diaspora.

This is the first visit to New Zealand by an Indian prime minister in 40 years.

Modi was received by Luxon at the airport.

“Reached Auckland a short while ago. Thankful to Prime Minister Luxon for the welcome at the airport,” Modi said in a post on X.

“This visit is historic, being the first Prime Ministerial visit to New Zealand in four decades. I look forward to holding talks with Prime Minister Luxon and discussing the complete range of the India-NZ friendship. I will also be addressing a community programme tomorrow in Auckland,” he said.

In a post on X, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said, “This historic visit is set to strengthen bilateral ties and unlock new avenues of cooperation across several areas especially trade, defence, sports, culture, education, and people-to-people exchanges.”

Continued on P4

CHEQUE-BOUNCE CASES

Delhi HC upholds Rajpal Yadav’s conviction, sentences him to 3 months in jail

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday upheld actor Rajpal Yadav’s conviction in seven cheque bounce cases, refusing to excuse a delay of more than five years in challenging the verdict. The court sentenced him to three months’ simple imprisonment in each case and directed him to pay a fine of Rs 1.05 crore in each complaint, while keeping the sentence in abeyance for two months to allow him to approach an appellate court.

Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma dismissed applications seeking condonation of a delay of 1,894 days in filing the revision petitions and, as a result, rejected the petitions themselves. The court also ordered that over Rs 2 crore already deposited by Yadav



Continued on P4

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday witnessed tense scenes after a petitioner appearing in person disrupted proceedings by throwing case papers inside the courtroom and allegedly using abusive language against the Chief Justice of India during the hearing of his appeal. Security personnel escorted him out, while the bench chose not to initiate any action against him and later dismissed his plea on merits.

The incident took place before a bench of Justices K V Viswanathan and Alok Aradhe during the hearing of an appeal filed by Prabal Pratap. The petition challenged an Allahabad High Court order that had dismissed his plea against the conversion of his application under Section 173(4) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) into a private complaint.

At the start of the hearing, Pratap addressed the bench in an unusual man-

ner, saying, “Mr judicial servant, I order you to order the registration of an FIR against ACP Vikas Nagar, Lucknow.”

Taken aback by the remark, Justice Viswanathan asked, “You are ordering me? You are ordering us?” The petitioner then replied, “That is all from my side. Everything is on record.”

Shortly afterwards, the petitioner flung his case papers inside the courtroom and allegedly shouted abusive remarks against Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, who was not part of the bench hearing the matter. Security personnel intervened immediately and removed him from the courtroom, allowing the proceedings to continue.

In its order, the bench noted that the petitioner, instead of arguing his case, had made “incoherent and unparliamentary utterances”. However, it took a lenient view, observing that, “considering the condition of the petitioner above named”, it did not propose to take **Continued on P4**

Govt mandates licensing for medicinal formulations with over 12% alcohol

Ayurvedic, Siddha and Unani syrups remain capped at 16% alcohol

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre has ended the licensing exemption for medicinal formulations containing more than 12 per cent ethyl alcohol, bringing them under stricter regulatory control to prevent misuse and diversion for intoxication, officials said on Friday.

Under the revised rules, medicinal formulations containing more than 12 per cent volume per volume (v/v) ethyl alcohol in quantities above 30 ml will no longer qualify for the exemption available under Schedule K of the Drugs Rules, 1945. Manufacturers will now have to obtain licences under

KEY POINTS

- » Rule applies to products exceeding 30 ml quantity.
- » Affected formulations now require licences under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act.
- » High alcohol medicinal products shifted to Schedule H1.
- » Sale allowed only against a registered doctor’s prescription.
- » Stricter record-keeping mandated for sale of these products.

the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940.

The amendment also places these products under Schedule H1 of the Drugs Rules, making them available only on the prescription of a registered medical practitioner and subject to stricter record-keeping requirements.

According to the health min-

istry, some medicinal preparations exempted under Schedule K, including tinctures of cardamom, ginger and other aromatic ingredients, contain very high levels of ethyl alcohol, in some cases as much as 80 to 90 per cent v/v. The ministry said it also received representations **Continued on P4**

FRANCE MARCH ON



Kilian Mbappe celebrates after France defeat Morocco in the FIFA World Cup quarterfinal

AP/PTI

Over half of Ram Temple donation counting staff quit

LUCKNOW (UP): The investigation into the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram Temple has led to the resignation of more than half of the employees engaged in counting devotees’ offerings, leaving only around a dozen personnel on the job, sources said on Friday.

According to trust sources, attendance at the donation counting centre had already fallen after the case surfaced. Of the nearly 40 people assigned to the work, only 15 to 20 had been reporting regularly due to concerns arising from the ongoing investigation. Around 20 employees have now resigned.

Those who quit cited a heavier workload following the alleged theft. They said the counting process, which earlier operated in two shifts, has been reduced to a single shift lasting nine to 10 hours without any increase in wages. Employees also said donations, once counted on tables and chairs, are now counted while sitting on the floor.

Security arrangements at the counting centre have been tightened. Staff members now undergo multiple rounds of frisking, are allowed to enter only barefoot and cannot carry mobile phones or personal belongings. **Continued on P4**

Top Court to hear Ram Temple donation case pleas on July 13

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court will hear on July 13 a batch of petitions seeking a fair and time-bound investigation into the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya. According to the court’s website, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana will take up three pleas when the court reopens on Monday.

The petitions seek a court-monitored CBI probe, while one filed by RJD MP Sudhakar Singh also seeks a forensic audit of the finances of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust. Petitioner Narendra Kumar Goswami has additionally sought a Comptroller and Auditor General audit of the Trust’s accounts.

Another plea by advocates Ajay Kumar Rai and Dinesh Kumar Yadav has sought a CBI-led multidisciplinary SIT to examine alleged financial irregularities and asked for regulatory and audit mechanisms to protect public interest and maintain devotees’ confidence. **Continued on P4**

ED raids Shekhar Suman associate in FEMA case

Finds evidence of undisclosed foreign assets and offshore bank accounts

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has conducted searches against Kalanee Impex Private Limited and its director, businessman and film producer Dharmesh Narendra Sangani, who is associated with actor Shekhar Suman and is the co-founder of the Shekhar Suman Film Academy, in a Foreign Exchange Management **Continued on P4**

FIRST ALLOCATION LIST ON JULY 16

DU receives 1.9L UG applications

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi University has received over 1.9 lakh applications for undergraduate admissions in the 2026-27 academic session, with more than 1.64 lakh candidates completing preference filling as well, officials said on Friday.

According to the university, 1,90,645 candidates have registered themselves for the UG admission process through the Common Seat Allocation System (CSAS).

University officials added that 1,64,098 candidates have completed Phase II of the admission process, which involves filling programme and college preferences. The deadline for completing the process is 11.59 pm on Saturday, July 11. The university has also opened a one-time correction window from 10 am on Friday, allowing applicants to rectify mistakes in the details already submitted on the CSAS portal. The correction facility will remain available till 11.59 pm on Saturday.

The university announced the correction window after receiving requests from students who reported errors while filling out their details on the portal, officials said.

The registration process for undergraduate admissions began on June 26 and will close at 11.59 pm on Saturday.

Phase II of admissions, during which candidates are required to complete subject mapping and fill their programme and college prefer-



‘Candidates have been advised to carefully review programme, college preferences before the deadline, after which the choices will be locked’: DU

ences, opened on July 3.

During a webinar held earlier this week to guide applicants through the admission process, the university officials urged students to carefully complete subject mapping and preference filling before the deadline.

Admissions will be conducted for 73 undergraduate programmes offered across 69 colleges and departments, with a total of 71,624 seats available. Around 150 BA programme combinations are on offer, and the detailed seat matrix has already been uploaded on the university website, the officials said. Candidates have been advised to carefully review

their programme and college preferences before the deadline, after which the choices will be automatically locked, they added.

Admissions under supernumerary categories, including sports and extracurricular activities, will also be processed based on the candidate's preferences.

The first seat allocation list will be released on July 16.

After accepting an allotted seat and paying the admission fee, candidates can either freeze their admission or opt for an upgrade in subsequent rounds.

Students opting for an upgrade will be allowed to reorder their higher preferences before the next allocation round. The university has also introduced a virtual wallet mechanism for fee payment. The officials said candidates upgraded to another programme or college after paying the admission fee in the first round will have the amount automatically adjusted, eliminating the need for repeated payments.

The university plans to complete two rounds of admissions before the commencement of the academic session on July 28. The university released the third PG allocation list, making 1,765 fresh allocations, while 5,848 candidates have frozen seats. It also announced the second BTech allocation list, the first spot round for integrated law courses with 18 vacancies, and said 8,823 students registered for one-year PG programmes.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Traffic Police has issued over 48 lakh challans and registered more than 2,100 FIRs for dangerous driving so far this year, while making eight key road stretches signal-free and stepping up engineering measures to ease congestion across the national capital, officials said on Friday.

Addressing a press conference, Special Commissioner of Police (Traffic) Manish Aggarwal said the department is focusing on long-term engineering solutions alongside sustained enforcement to improve traffic movement.

A total of 48.42 lakh challans were issued for various traffic violations during the current year, up from 47.52 lakh in the corresponding period last year. Of these, 17.21 lakh were generated through Red-Light Violation Detection (RLVD) and Over Speed Violation Detection (OSVD) systems.

Aggarwal said the traffic police studied 25 road stretches to identify measures for easing congestion. Of these, eight have already been made signal-free by closing redundant traffic signals, removing unauthorised median cuts, providing U-turns and rationalising intersections. The corridors include the NSP-Rithala Metro Station stretch and Vikas Marg between Laxmi Nagar and Karkari More.

Another 25 stretches have now been identified for similar studies to assess whether they can also be converted into signal-free corridors, he added.

The officer said analytical data from navigation platforms showed congestion had reduced on several corridors during the October-December period following coordinated traffic management measures. “Our primary objective is better regulation of traffic. Consistent enforcement has also resulted in improved road discipline and has positively influ-



“Another 25 stretches have been identified for similar studies to assess if they can also be converted into signal-free corridors”

enced commuter behaviour,” Aggarwal said.

The traffic police, in coordination with agencies including the PWD, MCD, NHAI, DMRC and DTC, also undertook engineering interventions at major congestion hotspots such as ISBT Kash-

mere Gate, Majnu Ka Tila, Ashram Chowk, Adhchini village, Anand Vihar and Kalindi Kunj.

Aggarwal said 62 congestion points across the city were reviewed in a meeting chaired by the Lieutenant Governor. While noticeable improvement was observed at several locations, structural changes have been recommended for four stretches where results were not satisfactory.

Project SANGAM, launched on April 3 to encourage citizen participation in traffic management, has so far held 309 stakeholder meetings and received 514 suggestions. Of these, 368 have been implemented, while the remaining have been referred to the concerned agencies.

The Road Safety Cell reached more than 2.84 lakh school students and over 15.44 lakh members of the public through awareness campaigns during the first six months of the year. It also trained more than 11,000 DTC drivers and

conductors and sensitised over 12,000 TSR, taxi and e-rickshaw drivers.

Aggarwal also announced the launch of “Traffic Pathshala”, an initiative aimed at educating commuters on road safety, traffic discipline and responsible driving practices.

Ahead of the monsoon, Delhi Traffic Police identified 169 waterlogging-prone locations in coordination with civic agencies and shared the details with them. Six disaster management vehicles equipped with motor pumps and tree-cutting machines have been deployed for emergency response, while around 1,200 additional personnel provided by the Delhi government will be deployed on a rotational basis to manage traffic and respond to rain-related congestion.

Between January and June, 14 traffic police personnel were injured and one lost his life while performing traffic regulation and enforcement duties, the police said.

Police nab gangster after 800-km chase

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested a history-sheeter allegedly linked to the Ashok Pradhan gang and apprehended three juveniles after an 800-km inter-state chase, foiling a fresh escalation in a gang rivalry, officials said on Friday.

The police arrested Mohit Bhardwaj, 29, a bad character of Najafgarh, and apprehended three juveniles from Uttar Pradesh's Agra on Thursday, they said.

According to the police, the four were wanted in three separate cases involving knife assault, abduction and attempt to murder registered in



‘A car used in one of the abduction cases was also recovered in the op’

connection with the ongoing rivalry between two factions of the Ashok Pradhan gang in the Najafgarh area.

According to the police, the

accused fled Delhi and frequently changed locations across Haryana, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh to evade arrest. After tracking their movements for several days, a team raided their hideout in Agra and apprehended Mohit along with three juveniles.

A car allegedly used in one of the abduction cases registered on June 15 was also recovered during the operation. Police said Mohit is an active member of the Ashok Pradhan gang and has a criminal record involving offences such as murder, attempt to murder, armed robbery and violations of the Arms Act. Further investigation is underway.

Gold appraiser held for ₹3.81 cr fake loan fraud

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A gold appraiser of a non-banking financial company (NBFC) has been arrested for allegedly conspiring with others to create 683 fake gold loan accounts using forged documents and artificial gold ornaments to fraudulently obtain loans worth over Rs 3.81 crore, an official of the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) said on Friday.

The accused, Pankaj Kumar, was working as a gold appraiser with a private company and was arrested on July 7 following an investigation into the alleged fraud, he said.

According to the EOW, the case came to light after the company's internal audit detected large-scale irregularities in its gold loan portfolio.

“The audit found that nine packets of original pledged gold ornaments worth around Rs 14.11 lakh were missing. The audit further revealed that 683 fake gold loan accounts had been created between 2022 and 2025 using forged KYC documents, fake customer identities and artificial gold ornaments. Based on these accounts, loans amounting to about Rs 3.81 crore were fraudulently disbursed,” the statement of the EOW read.

An FIR was registered at the EOW police station in August 2025, and further investigation was

taken up. During the investigation, police examined loan files, appraisal reports, KYC documents, audit records, bank statements and other financial records, besides recording statements of company officials and other witnesses.

Police said that Kumar, in conspiracy with other accused, certified fake or artificial gold ornaments as genuine to sanction fraudulent loans, forged identity documents and fabricated loan records allegedly to create fake borrower accounts.

“To avoid detection during internal audits, the accused and his associates allegedly continued depositing interest in the fake loan accounts and made false entries in the company's loan management system to project them as regular and active,” read the statement. Kumar, a University of Delhi graduate, had been working with the company since 2014 and was responsible for evaluating pledged gold ornaments, verifying customer documents and processing gold loan applications.

During interrogation, he disclosed the modus operandi adopted in executing the fraud. Police said efforts are underway to identify the source of the fake gold ornaments, trace the proceeds of crime, recover the missing property and ascertain the involvement of other persons in the conspiracy. Further investigation is in progress.

City Briefs

FOUR DEAD IN GGM POLICE ENCOUNTER

GURUGRAM: Four associates of wanted gangster Deepak Nandal were killed and one injured in an encounter with Gurugram Police after they allegedly held property dealer Vishal Beri hostage at his Sushant Lok residence while attempting to extort several crores of rupees. More than 60 rounds were fired during the exchange, in which three police personnel were also injured. Police rescued Beri safely and recovered five pistols, over 50 empty cartridges, live ammunition and a Scorpio SUV. Nandal, who is based abroad, is wanted in multiple cases.

INTERSTATE ROBBERY GANG BUSTED; 4 HELD

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested four members of an interstate robbery gang that allegedly targeted people after they withdrew cash from banks. The accused were held in connection with a daylight robbery in Paharganj on July 8, in which a man was robbed of Rs 50,000 after withdrawing Rs 1 lakh from a bank in Jhandewalan. Police recovered the entire stolen amount and the motorcycle used in the crime.

TEEN NABBED FOR MAKING VIDEOS WITH GUNS

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested an 18-year-old man from northeast Delhi's Gokalpuri for allegedly flaunting illegal firearms in social media videos. The accused, identified as Manish alias Kangla, was apprehended during patrolling, and two country-made pistols were recovered from his house. He admitted the weapons shown in the videos were real after initially attempting to evade verification. An FIR has been registered under the Arms Act. The accused was previously involved in a case registered at Farsh Bazar. Further investigation is underway.

Air, water around Delhi landfills under threat

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi's three towering landfill sites at Ghazipur, Bhalswa and Okhla are emerging as one of the capital's biggest environmental and public health challenges, with toxic leachate contaminating groundwater and hazardous gases polluting the air, posing serious health risks to residents living nearby.

People residing around the landfill sites allege that contaminated groundwater, persistent foul odour and constant exposure to toxic emissions have become part of their daily lives, while environmental experts warn that the crisis could worsen without urgent scientific waste management measures.



At Baleshwar Dairy Farm near the Bhalswa landfill, residents claim groundwater drawn through borewells has turned yellow, foul-smelling and unfit for drinking or domestic use. Similar complaints have been raised by people living near the Ghazipur landfill, where residents say the stench has made normal life difficult and respiratory and waterborne illnesses have become

increasingly common.

Environmentalist Dr Manu Singh said landfill sites gradually develop into toxic ecosystems that contaminate groundwater with heavy metals, ammonia, disease-causing microorganisms and harmful organic chemicals. They also release methane, hydrogen sulphide and other hazardous gases that significantly degrade air quality, increasing the

risk of respiratory illnesses, skin diseases, neurological disorders and certain cancers.

According to a 2025 report submitted by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) to the National Green Tribunal (NGT), Delhi generates nearly 11,852 tonnes of solid waste every day. Of this, only 7,585.28 tonnes — around 64 per cent — is scientifically processed or recycled, while the remaining 4,266.72 tonnes is dumped at landfill sites. Experts have called for scientific waste segregation, improved recycling, effective leachate treatment, methane capture and stronger groundwater protection, warning that the city's landfill crisis has become a major public health emergency.

Court acquits man as key witness dies

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court has acquitted a man accused of attempting to murder his wife, holding that the prosecution failed to prove its case after the complainant died before her testimony could be recorded.

Principal District and Sessions Judge Sanjay Sharma acquitted Abhinesh Tripathi alias Rahul, who was accused of attempting to murder his wife Rashmi in 2021.

According to the prosecution, Rashmi initially alleged that her husband assaulted her with a hockey stick and later claimed he threw her from the third floor of their house while intoxicated, prompting police to add the charge of attempt to murder.

During the trial, however, Rashmi could not be traced and her father later informed the court that she had died. He also said the couple had settled their disputes before her death, obtained a divorce by mutual consent and that Rashmi had received Rs 8 lakh as alimony.

The court observed that Rashmi was the sole material witness and the remaining witnesses were only formal police witnesses, whose evidence was insufficient to establish the charges beyond reasonable doubt.

Over 1.18 cr voters receive SIR forms; 7L digitised

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: More than 1.18 crore of Delhi's 1.45 crore electors have received enumeration forms under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, while over 7.09 lakh completed forms have been digitised, according to official data released on Friday.

A total of 1,18,00,240 forms have been distributed, covering

‘Door-to-door drive to continue till Jul 29’

81.32 per cent of the capital's 1,45,10,298 electors. The number of digitised forms stands at 7,09,499, or 4.89 per cent of the electorate. The door-to-door exercise, which began on June 30, will continue till July 29.

West district recorded the

highest distribution at 90.78 per cent, while South West reported the lowest at 72.03 per cent. In digitisation, Outer North topped the list with 12.19 per cent, followed by South West at 7.72 per cent.

The Election Commission said voters can also submit their enumeration forms online. The final electoral roll will be published on October 7 after completion of the revision exercise.

HOSPITAL OWNER, ASHA WORKER AMONG THOSE HELD

10 more nabbed as Delhi Police rescue four children in infant trafficking case

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested 10 more accused, including biological parents, traffickers, mediators, buyers and a hospital owner, in connection with an interstate infant trafficking racket that allegedly procured newborns from vulnerable families and sold them to childless couples for lakhs of rupees.

Police also rescued four more children from Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, taking the total number of rescued infants and children to nine.

The arrests followed an investigation launched after



the Anti-Narcotics Cell of the Central District conducted a decoy operation near RK Ashram Metro Station in Paharganj on June 5.

During the operation, three accused — Jyoti alias Kamlesh, Shalu and Lalit — were arrested while allegedly attempting to sell a four-to-five-day-old newborn boy to decoy buyers. The

infant was rescued safely and the Rs 20,000 paid as token money was recovered.

An FIR was registered at Paharganj Police Station under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Juvenile Justice Act. A Special Investigation Team (SIT), supervised by Additional DCP-II Prashant Chaudhary, was subsequently formed to probe the case.

The investigation uncovered an organised interstate syndicate that allegedly operated on a demand-and-supply model, identifying childless couples willing to pay substantial sums before sourcing infants from financially dis-

tressed biological parents.

Among those arrested are an ASHA worker who allegedly acted as a mediator, biological parents from Gujarat, a hospital owner accused of facilitating illegal transfers, buyers from Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, and Shankar Gamar, identified as a key supplier.

Police said bank transactions worth several lakhs have been traced and hospital and birth records are being examined. All nine rescued children have been produced before the Child Welfare Committee for care, protection and rehabilitation. Further investigation is underway.

Fresh bids invited for Noida Authority's Sports Complex

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Noida Authority has reissued the tender for the proposed sports complex in Sector 123 after receiving an inadequate response during the first round of bidding. Interested agencies have been given an additional 15 days to submit their bids, with officials expecting the tendering process to conclude next month so construction can begin without further delay.

The sports complex will be developed over nearly 26.65 acres at an estimated cost of around Rs 145 crore. The project will be executed in two phases. The first phase, estimated at Rs 71 crore, includes a synthetic athletics track, javelin

DIPIKA KIROLA

‘Complex will be developed over nearly 26 acres’

throw arena, swimming pool, football ground, spectators' gallery and a multi-purpose indoor hall. The remaining infrastructure will be developed in the second phase. Once completed, the Authority plans to appoint a separate agency to manage and operate the facility.

The complex will feature a wide range of indoor and outdoor sports facilities. Indoor amenities will include badminton, table tennis, wrestling and squash courts, while the outdoor infrastructure will cater to cricket, football, volleyball,

kabaddi, lawn tennis, kho-kho, gymnastics, long jump, high jump and a 200-metre athletics track.

At present, the Sector 21A Stadium is Noida's primary sports venue and experiences heavy footfall, often limiting practice opportunities for athletes.

Officials said the new sports complex will help reduce the burden on the existing stadium while providing modern sporting infrastructure to residents and athletes from Sectors 119, 120, 121 and 122, Parthala, Sarfabad and Greater Noida West. The project is expected to strengthen sports infrastructure in the region and encourage greater participation among young athletes.

16 IVP COUNCILLORS MERGE WITH BJP, BOOSTING PARTY'S STRENGTH IN MCD TO 139

MCD math tilts towards BJP

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant political development ahead of key civic decisions in the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), all 16 councillors of the Indraprastha Vikas Party (IVP), led by former AAP leader Mukesh Goyal, joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Friday. The merger raises the BJP's strength in the 250-member MCD House to 139 councillors, further consolidating its position in the civic body.

The merger was announced at the Delhi BJP state office by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra in the presence of Mukesh Goyal and the 16 councillors. Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi, Leader of the House Jaibhagwan Yadav and other BJP leaders were also present. The IVP was formed on May 17, 2025, after 16 councillors quit the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) under the leadership of Mukesh Goyal.

Welcoming the merger, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the induction of the councillors would strengthen the government's development



BJP MP Harsh Malhotra offers sweets to Mukesh Goyal after he and 16 IVP councillors joined the BJP, as CM Rekha Gupta looks on during a press conference at the Delhi BJP state office, in New Delhi, on Friday

agenda in Delhi. "I assure all the councillors and the workers who have joined the BJP along with them that they will receive full respect within the BJP family and every opportunity to serve," she said.

The Chief Minister said she had worked with several of the councillors in the past and was familiar with their capabilities. She added that residents of their wards would now benefit from the devel-

opment initiatives of what she described as the BJP's "triple-engine government."

Gupta also linked the merger to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership. "Only a few days ago, an entire political party in West Bengal accepted Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership and joined the BJP, and today the merger of the Indraprastha Vikas Party into the BJP in Delhi once again reflects the Prime Minister's growing popu-

larity and the public's confidence in his leadership," she said. Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra said the merger would directly connect nearly 11 to 12 lakh residents across the 16 wards with the BJP government's development programmes.

"The merger of the Indraprastha Vikas Party with the BJP has been inspired by the desire of its 16 councillors to connect the people of their wards with the all-round devel-

"I assure all the councillors and the workers who have joined the BJP along with them that they will receive full respect within the BJP family and every opportunity to serve"

— CM REKHA GUPTA

opment being carried out by the Rekha Gupta Government under the guidance of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. I welcome everyone into the BJP family," Malhotra said. He also claimed that the Rekha Gupta government had provided a Rs.1 crore development fund to every MCD councillor, irrespective of party affiliation, and said the initiative had helped improve civic management during the ongoing monsoon. Explaining the reasons behind joining the BJP, Mukesh Goyal criticised the AAP's tenure in the MCD.

"When the Aam Aadmi Party came to power, I was appointed Leader of the House in the Municipal Corporation in 2023. However, that tenure proved to be a dark chapter for us because no developmental work was carried out; it was

only marked by political rhetoric," Goyal said. He alleged that councillors did not receive development funds during the AAP's tenure and claimed that the BJP had extended cooperation after the IVP was formed. He said the decision to merge with the BJP was taken "unanimously and unconditionally."

The 16 councillors who joined the BJP include Mukesh Goyal, Hemchand Goyal, Devendra Kumar, Usha Sharma, Dinesh Kumar, Suman Anil Rana, Manisha Jasveer Karala, Babi Ji, Runakshi Sharma, Rajesh Ladi, Sahib Kumar, Rakhi Yadav, Kamal Bhardwaj, Leena Kumar, Himani Jain and Ashok Pandey. With their induction, the BJP has further strengthened its numerical advantage in the Municipal Corporation of Delhi.

CM seeks NH tag for MANDI ROAD

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has urged Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari to declare South Delhi's Mandi Road a National Highway and bring it under the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), saying the move would improve connectivity across Delhi-NCR and support regional economic growth.

In a letter to Gadkari, Gupta said the 8.8-km-long Mandi Road is a strategically important transport corridor connecting Mehrauli-Gurugram Road (NH-148A) near Chhatrapur Metro Station with the Gurugram-Faridabad Road at the Delhi-Haryana border. She said the road serves as a key link between Delhi and the neighbouring economic centres of Gurugram and Faridabad while facilitating smooth inter-state traffic movement.

Calling for the road's inclusion under the NHAI, Gupta said, "Mandi Road is a key strategic transport corridor in Delhi-NCR." She added that its strategic importance, increasing traffic volume and direct connectivity with NH-148A make it suitable for National Highway status.

The Chief Minister also referred to the Unified Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure (Planning & Engineering) Centre (UTTIPCE), noting that its 68th Governing Body meet-



ing held on September 27, 2023, had recognised the importance of Mandi Road and supported its widening and comprehensive development. In her letter, Gupta requested Gadkari to "declare Mandi Road a National Highway and entrust its development to the NHAI so that an integrated development plan can be prepared, uniform engineering standards can be adopted, and the timely upgradation of this important corridor can be ensured."

She said the proposal would improve daily commuting and strengthen regional infrastructure. "The initiative would provide better and smoother travel for commuters who use the road every day. It would also strengthen connectivity across Delhi-NCR and give fresh momentum to regional economic growth," she said.



'Catch the Rain' to reach 75 schools

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a move that combines education, environmental awareness and water conservation, the Delhi government on Friday signed a tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Indraprastha Gas Limited and Ehsaas NGO to install modern rainwater harvesting systems in 75 CM Shri Schools across the Capital under the 'Catch the Rain' initiative.

The agreement was signed at the Delhi Secretariat in the presence of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. The project, funded through IGL's Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) programme, will include technical audits of existing rainwater harvesting structures, restoration of old systems, installation of new rooftop harvesting units, and water conservation workshops for students and teachers.

Calling water conservation essential for the future, the Chief Minister said, "Water conservation is not merely an environmental necessity but the foundation of a secure future for coming generations." She added that the initiative reflects the government's effort to promote education and environmental responsibility together.

Gupta said the project would begin with 75 schools but could eventually be expanded to nearly 800 government schools across Delhi. "The government's objective is to install rainwater harvesting systems in all government schools in Delhi and make

"Water conservation is not merely an environmental necessity but the foundation of a secure future for coming generations"

— CM

them fully functional," she said.

Under the 12-month project, each school will receive a modern rooftop rainwater harvesting unit equipped with pipelines, filters, tanks and recharge structures. Maintenance and technical support will be provided for one year, while the Directorate of Education will oversee long-term upkeep after completion.

Officials estimate that each school could recharge around two lakh litres of groundwater annually, contributing significantly to groundwater conservation in the capital.

Education Minister Ashish Sood said, "The 'Catch the Rain' campaign is an integral part of this broader vision." He added that the initiative would encourage students to adopt sustainable lifestyles and support the government's target of converting all 1,000 government schools into Zero Waste Campuses.

The Delhi government said the success of the pilot project would determine its phased expansion to other government and Municipal Corporation of Delhi schools in the coming years.

Delhi government gets new voices

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday appointed MLA Abhay Kumar Verma as the Chief Spokesperson of the Delhi government, while MLA Anil Kumar Sharma and Harish Khurana have been named government spokespersons. The appointments have come into effect immediately.

According to the Chief Minister's Office, the move aims to strengthen transparent, accountable and citizen-centric governance by ensuring timely dissemination of official information on government policies, decisions and public welfare initiatives.

Abhay Verma named chief spokesperson; Anil Sharma, Harish Khurana join as spokespersons

The newly appointed Chief Spokesperson and spokespersons will present the Delhi government's authorised position on key issues, communicate official information related to policy decisions, development works and welfare schemes, and interact with the media on behalf of the government.

They will also provide factual clarifications on government decisions whenever required and convey the government's perspective based on authorised inputs received from various departments.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the appointments are intended to establish a structured and credible communication mechanism between the government, citizens and the media. She said official and factual information regarding the government's initiatives would now be communicated in a more timely and organised manner.

Emphasising the importance of effective communica-

tion in a democratic system, the Chief Minister said transparent and authentic dissemination of information is an essential pillar of good governance. She added that the appointment of a Chief Spokesperson and spokespersons would further strengthen dialogue with citizens while ensuring that verified information about government policies, development initiatives and public welfare programmes reaches the public without delay.

The government said the new communication framework would help improve coordination with the media and enhance public awareness about its decisions and welfare measures.

Online gate pass payment system launched at Azadpur Mandi

NEW DELHI: The Azadpur Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee (APMC) on Friday launched an online payment facility for gate pass fees, replacing the largely cash-based system with a digital mechanism, officials said. The move is aimed at reducing congestion and improving transparency at Asia's largest wholesale fruits and vegetables market.

Officials said traders, vehicle drivers and other stakeholders entering the mandi can now pay gate pass fees through digital modes, adding that the move is expected to speed up vehicle entry and reduce traffic snarls at the gates. "The online payment system will save time for traders and ensure a faster and more secure payment process," APMC Azadpur Secretary Ayushi said.

Officials further said the facility would soon be extended to all mandis under the Delhi Agricultural Marketing Board.

"Our objective is to promote digital governance across Delhi's agricultural markets and minimise cash transactions, making operations more efficient and convenient for all stakeholders," Delhi Agricultural Marketing Board Vice Chairman Arjun Sharma said.



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh during a meeting with CM Rekha Gupta during his birthday, in New Delhi

L-G eyes Dwarka business hub

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday directed Delhi Development Authority (DDA) to posit Dwarka sub-city as a "clean, employment-generating and major investment destination".

Sandhu, who chaired a meeting of several stakeholders including officials from the industries and tourism departments, urged the authorities to implement measures to develop Dwarka into a major economic and commercial hub.

"The L-G said Dwarka's proximity to the international airport, its seamless connectivity, and its maturing urban ecosystem together make it

investment-ready across sectors, creating opportunities in commerce, hospitality, health-care, education and technology," DDA said in a statement.

During the interaction, the L-G emphasised that urban redevelopment and infrastructure upgrade are essential to sustaining Delhi's long-term economic growth.

The L-G placed particular emphasis on ensuring that Dwarka's industrial growth remains clean, sustainable and non-polluting, staving off industries that could compromise the sub-city's environmental quality.

"The L-G stated that focus should be on fostering a labour-centric industrial base capable of generating large-scale employ-

ment opportunities for the local workforce, so that Dwarka's economic rise translates directly into livelihood gains for the people of Delhi," DDA said.

During the meeting, DDA officials informed L-G Sandhu that land has been made available to support future investments and the authority is working closely with stakeholder agencies to streamline approval processes.

"The recently approved Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) Policy, formulated under the guidance of L-G, brings together all concerned agencies to facilitate seamless, single-point and time-bound approvals for eligible projects," official said.

Pink paper ticket ERA ends July 31

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government on Friday announced that women commuters will be able to use the existing paper-based Pink Tickets for free travel in Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses only till July 31, after which the National Common Mobility Card (NCMC)-based Pink Saheli Smart Card will become the sole mode for availing the benefit from August 1.

The government said the transition is aimed at making the scheme more transparent, efficient and technology-driven while ensuring that women continue to receive free travel without any disruption.

Delhi Transport Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh urged eligible women who have not yet obtained the smart card to complete the registration process at the earliest. According to the government, around 15 lakh Pink Saheli Smart Cards have already been issued, and a majority of women commuters

are using them regularly. Assuring commuters that the free travel scheme will continue uninterrupted, Singh said, "The free bus travel facility for Delhi's women will continue uninterrupted. We appeal to all eligible women to obtain their Pink Saheli Smart Card and avail its benefits with ease and convenience."

He added, "There is absolutely no reason for anyone to panic. Pink Tickets will remain valid till July 31, and from August 1, women possessing the Pink Saheli Smart Card will continue to travel free of cost."

Highlighting the benefits of the new system, the minister said the card would help bring "greater transparency, efficiency and accountability" while improving beneficiary management and streamlining implementation of the scheme.

The Transport Minister also clarified that July 31 is not the last date to apply for the Pink Saheli Smart Card.

Delhi zoo welcomes 3 Asiatic lion cubs in rare repeat breeding



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Fresh roars are set to echo through the Delhi zoo as Asiatic lioness Mahagauri has given birth to three cubs, adding a fresh chapter to the zoo's conservation efforts and marking a rare repeat breeding success after her earlier litter of five cubs last year, of which two survived.

The three Asiatic lion cubs were born on Tuesday at the National Zoological Park to the

breeding pair of Mahagauri and Maheshwar. The newborns are currently kept with their mother in a secure maternity enclosure, zoo Director Sanjeet Kumar said. The official said the cubs are being provided a calm and undisturbed environment crucial for their early development, with veterinary and animal care teams monitoring their health through CCTV surveillance and regular observation.

The successful breeding of Mahagauri and Maheshwar is

considered significant as the pair had earlier produced two healthy cubs - Kartik and Karni - on April 27, 2025. Mahagauri became the first lioness at the Delhi zoo since 2009 to conceive again within around a year of giving birth, a rare occurrence in the facility's recent breeding history, Kumar said.

According to him, lion breeding at the zoo remained stable until 2009, with cubs born every few years. However, the programme witnessed a sharp

decline thereafter, with births becoming increasingly infrequent and nearly coming to a standstill at one point.

By 2021, Sundaram, a lion born at the zoo in 2009, was the only Asiatic lion left at the facility. Now 17 years old, Sundaram's ageing prompted the authorities to look for new breeding stock to revive the Asiatic lion population. As part of the revival plan, the zoo brought one male and two female lions - Maheshwar, Mahagauri

and Shailja - from Junagadh in Gujarat in 2021. The trio, born in 2020, was expected to strengthen Delhi zoo's breeding programme, Kumar said.

However, the plan suffered a setback after Shailja sustained a serious injury while moving around her enclosure. She later developed a paralysis-like condition in her hind limbs, affecting her ability to breed, the official said. With Shailja unable to contribute to the breeding efforts, the responsibility of expanding

the zoo's Asiatic lion population rested largely on Mahagauri and Maheshwar.

Their first successful breeding resulted in the birth of five cubs on April 27, 2025. The first litter also highlighted the challenges associated with lion breeding, as three cubs died shortly after birth due to developmental issues. The remaining two survived after veterinarians provided artificial cat milk when Mahagauri was unable to nurse them, Kumar said.

JAISHANKAR ON VISIT TO GULF COUNTRIES

Jaishankar meets Omani counterpart, discusses regional developments

MUSCAT: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Friday met his Omani counterpart Sayyid Badr Albusaidi and the two leaders reviewed the full spectrum of the Strategic Partnership and exchanged views on regional and global issues.

Jaishankar, who is on a visit to Gulf countries, arrived in Oman earlier in the day.

The minister, in a social media post, said he was delighted to meet the Omani foreign minister and hold discussions on “various facets of our cooperation.”

“Focused on trade, investments, connectivity, maritime, technology, defence and cyber & AI domains. Had a comprehensive exchange of views on developments in the Gulf, and efforts to ensure peace and stability,” he said.

The two ministers reviewed the full spectrum of the India-Oman Strategic Partnership and exchanged views on



External Affairs minister S Jaishankar with Oman Foreign Affairs Minister Badr Albusaidi during a meeting, in Muscat PTI

regional and global issues of mutual interest, the Ministry of External Affairs said in a statement.

Jaishankar also conveyed India's appreciation to the

Oman government for the prompt assistance extended to Indian seafarers during the recent regional developments, it added.

Three Indian seafarers were

Highlights

» 'The two ministers re-viewed the full spectrum of the India-Oman Strategic Partnership and exchanged views on regional and global issues of mutual interest'

» Jaishankar also conveyed India's appreciation to the Oman government for the prompt assistance extended to Indian seafarers during the recent regional developments, MEA added

came two days after a Palau-flagged vessel with 24 Indians came under attack by the US Navy as the ship tried to evade the US blockade of Iranian ports.

India has voiced its firm opposition to attacks on merchant shipping amid the ongoing Iran conflict, and told the UN Security Council that several of its nationals have died or are missing due to attacks in the region.

The external affairs minister also interacted with members of the Indian community in Oman and appreciated their continued contribution towards further strengthening the multifaceted India-Oman relationship, the release said.

“A good interaction with members of Indian diaspora in Oman this morning. Their enthusiasm in strengthening India-Oman relations was palpable,” Jaishankar posted on X.

Rajnath lauds Navy's role in safeguarding maritime interests

OUR CORRESPONDENT

VISAKHAPATNAM: Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Friday lauded the Indian Navy for safeguarding the country's maritime interests, asserting that India stands as the primary guarantor of peace and stability in the Indian Ocean Region.

Addressing naval personnel on the eve of the commissioning of Mahendragiri, the sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate, he said the Navy was protecting India's maritime borders, securing vital sea lanes and upholding the country's interests amid an increasingly complex global security environment.

“India stands as the primary guarantor of peace and stability in the Indian Ocean Region (IOR),” a PIB press release quoted him as saying.

Highlighting the strategic significance of the IOR, Singh said over 90 percent of India's trade by volume passes through maritime routes, while the country's energy security, Exclusive Economic Zone and island territories make mari-



Defence minister Rajnath Singh arrives in Visakhapatnam PTI

time security central to economic growth and national interests.

He said increasing geopolitical competition and the growing presence of extra-regional powers have made heightened maritime vigilance essential.

Describing India as the largest and most responsible stakeholder in the IOR, the defence minister reaffirmed the country's commitment to peace, stability and a secure maritime environment.

“The region is our court-yard, and securing the court-yard is our responsibility,” he said.

Singh termed the commissioning of Mahendragiri another shining example of India's growing indigenous defence capabilities and progress towards self-reliance.

He credited the valour, commitment and patriotism of the armed forces for protecting the country from threats and challenges while urging personnel to continuously upgrade their skills and master cutting-edge technologies.

Stressing that the nature of warfare is evolving rapidly, he said future conflicts could emerge in new and unforeseen forms, including those fought without a formal declaration of war, and warned that tomorrow's adversary may not resemble those of the past.

He urged soldiers to remain physically and mentally prepared and assured them that the government would leave no stone unturned to provide the armed forces with the world's best weaponry, technology and resources, while emphasising that wars are ultimately won by the people who wield those weapons.

From Page 1

E20 may cut

traced the programme's origins to a pilot project launched in 2001. The blending programme was formally announced in 2004 and E5 fuel was introduced in several states in 2006. Although blending remained around 1.5 per cent until 2014 because ethanol production relied mainly on sugarcane, the National Policy on Biofuels introduced in 2018 expanded feedstocks to include maize and surplus grain, allowing production to rise sharply.

The ministry said NITI Aayog released a detailed roadmap in 2021 after consulting automobile manufacturers, oil companies and agricultural experts. Around the same time, Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd invited private investment in dedicated ethanol plants backed by assured purchase agreements and financing support.

According to the government, ethanol blending increased steadily from about 8.1 per cent in 2020-21 to 10 per cent in 2021-22, 12.1 per cent in 2022-23, 14.6 per cent in 2023-24, 19.2 per cent in 2024-25 and 20 per cent during the current ethanol supply year.

The ministry acknowledged that some motorists could see a 3 to 5 per cent reduction in fuel economy after switching to E20. However, it said mileage is influenced by several other factors, including driving habits, tyre pressure, servicing and air conditioner usage.

It argued that E20 provides several technical advantages over conventional petrol. Ethanol has a Research Octane Number of around 108.5 compared with about 84.4 for petrol, raising the effective octane rating of Indian petrol to roughly 95. According to the ministry, this results in better combustion, superior anti-knock properties, smoother acceleration, faster combustion, improved pickup, cleaner engine operation and significantly lower particulate emissions. It also said lifecycle carbon emissions can fall by nearly 40 per cent.

The government also rejected concerns that E20 damages engines, fuel lines or rubber components, particularly in older vehicles not originally certified for the higher blend.

It said extensive laboratory testing and field validation were carried out before nationwide introduction, covering engine durability, corrosion resistance, drivability, emissions, material compatibility and fuel system performance. The ministry said expert committees involving the Automotive Research Association of India, the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, automobile companies and oil firms guided the transition from E10 to E20.

Citing industry feedback, the ministry said Maruti Suzuki serviced 2.84 crore vehicles during the 2025-26 financial year, including 1.5 crore older vehicles that were not originally certified for E20, and reported no E20-related corrosion, abnormal wear or reduction in component life. Hero MotoCorp also reported similar field experience.

“If E20 genuinely damaged rubber hoses, fuel lines or engines, this would have shown up as a wave of warranty claims and complaints. That wave never happened,” the

ministry said. The government added that ethanol and blended petrol conform to strict Bureau of Indian Standards specifications and undergo quality checks throughout the supply chain, from distilleries to depots and retail outlets. It said state governments have also been instructed to maintain zero tolerance against adulteration.

Responding to demands that consumers should be allowed to choose between pure petrol, E10 and E20, the ministry said such a system would be impractical given India's fuel distribution network of more than one lakh retail outlets linked through refineries, pipelines, terminals and depots.

Maintaining three parallel grades of base fuel would increase logistics costs, complicate inventory management and reduce operational efficiency, it said. The ministry also noted that public sector banks have financed nearly Rs 1 lakh crore every year in ethanol plants, storage and logistics infrastructure. Reverting to lower blend levels would leave much of that investment underutilised while affecting farmers, cooperatives, entrepreneurs and financial institutions that invested based on national policy.

The ministry also explained why E20 is not sold at a lower price despite ethanol being domestically produced. It said ethanol procurement prices are fixed to ensure fair returns to farmers. For instance, maize-based ethanol is procured at around Rs 71.86 per litre before taxes, transport and storage. When global crude oil prices remain around 70 US dollars per barrel, E20 may cost as much as or even more than conventional petrol. Ethanol becomes cheaper only when crude prices rise sharply to around 120 to 130 US dollars per barrel.

Even so, the ministry said consumers benefit because nearly one-fifth of every litre of petrol sold is sourced domestically, reducing India's exposure to fluctuations in global crude prices and supply disruptions.

The government also pointed to fuel price trends between June 2022 and June 2026, saying petrol prices in Delhi increased by only 5.58 per cent during the period, compared with increases of nearly 40 per cent in Pakistan and Bangladesh, over 36 per cent in Sri Lanka, around 20 per cent in Nepal and about 18 to 19 per cent in major European countries including France, Germany and Italy. According to the ministry, since the 2014-15 ethanol supply year, the programme has saved more than Rs 1.97 lakh crore in foreign exchange, displaced nearly 316 lakh tonnes of crude oil imports, reduced around 952 lakh tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions and transferred over Rs 1.66 lakh crore to farmers.

The ministry also highlighted that ethanol blending is widely used internationally. The United States has adopted E10 as its standard petrol blend and is expanding E15, while many flex-fuel vehicles there can use blends up to E85. Brazil currently mandates E27 and is moving towards around 35 per cent blending, with more than 80 per cent of new vehicles capable of running on higher ethanol blends or pure hydrous ethanol. Japan, Canada, Thailand and several European countries have also adopted ethanol blending as part of their clean fuel strategies.

The clarification comes amid continuing public debate over E20 fuel and reports that the government may delay its proposed move to E25 as it reviews concerns raised by consumers and industry.

Trump

of violating the agreement. Disagreements over navigation through the strategic waterway remain a key source of tension. Iran has argued that the agreement allows it to influence the movement of ships through the strait, while the United States maintains that the deal guarantees free passage for commercial vessels.

Qatari negotiators met Iranian officials on Friday in an effort to reduce tensions and discuss implementation of the memorandum, including the navigation dispute, according to a source familiar with the talks. Iran's semi-official Tasnim news agency also reported that a Qatari delegation had visited Tehran as Doha sought to continue its role as a mediator.

Trump did not clarify whether the proposed talks would focus on ending the renewed hostilities or address broader issues such as Iran's nuclear programme, frozen Iranian assets and the future administration of the Strait of Hormuz. Oil prices eased on Friday but were still on track for weekly gains of about 5 per cent as concerns over shipping disruptions and global energy supplies persisted.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

PM Modi

In his departure statement in New Delhi, the prime minister had said that his visit would “meaningfully build” upon the strong momentum in India-New Zealand ties pursuant to Luxon's visit to India in March 2025.

Modi said his visit to Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand will further strengthen India's Act East Policy, MAHASAGAR Vision, as well as its outlook towards a free and open Indo-Pacific.

PM Modi's two-day visit to New Zealand aims to deepen bilateral ties, building on Luxon's India visit and the recently signed India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement.

During his stay, PM Modi and his Kiwi counterpart are scheduled to hold wide-ranging discussions covering the full spectrum of bilateral relations, with a particular focus on expanding economic, trade and commercial cooperation.

Apart from the bilateral talks, the Prime Minister will engage with leading business and sports personalities in New Zealand.

Ram Temple

They also pass through several security checkpoints inside the temple complex, whereas trust-issued identity cards were earlier sufficient for entry.

Sources said four personnel have been assigned solely to monitor the counting process. The trust is also preparing QR code-enabled identity cards with digital security features, a common uniform for outsourced staff and a digital entry and exit tracking system.

The alleged siphoning of devotees' offerings before bank deposit came to light earlier this month. Eight people linked to the count-

ing and handling of donations have been arrested so far, while police and the temple trust continue parallel investigations.

Top Court

The petition said reports of missing funds had caused “deep concern” and argued that an independent professional investigation would inspire greater public confidence than the state SIT.

On July 7, an Ayodhya court granted one-day police remand for accused Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra and Karunesh Pandey. All eight accused were sent to 14-day judicial custody on June 29 after the Uttar Pradesh government formed an SIT on June 13.

Rain fury

into their vehicle.

Officials said 27 link roads in Shimla district remained closed, causing inconvenience to commuters. Rockfalls were reported on the Kalka-Shimla National Highway, particularly between Wagnaghat and Kandaghat and between Dharampur and Chakki Mod. Authorities also warned that continued rainfall could threaten the Sangla bridge in Kinnaur district, built last year with assistance from the Border Roads Organisation and the Indian Army. Any major damage to the bridge could cut off the Sangla Valley. The local meteorological office said Sirmour and Solan districts received the highest rainfall since Thursday evening.

Uttarakhand also remained on high alert after heavy rain over the past 24 hours triggered landslides and blocked 118 roads, including the Yamunotri National Highway. A teenager died and several people were injured in separate incidents. Schools remained closed in affected areas as authorities stepped up monitoring following forecasts of heavy to very heavy rainfall.

A landslide damaged a 100-metre stretch of the Yamunotri National Highway near Syanachatti in Uttarkashi district, where repair work is underway. The Gangothri National Highway also faced repeated disruptions due to falling rocks at Nagun and Nalu Pani. Continuous rainfall caused the Ganga, Yamuna and several tributaries to swell, increasing concerns in low-lying areas.

The Northeast continued to grapple with severe flooding and landslides. In Mizoram's Lunglei district, bordering Bangladesh, more than 80 families were shifted to safer places after the Khawthlangtuipui river overflowed following a week of relentless rain. Officials said landslides, rockfalls and other rain-related incidents had been reported at more than 29 locations across the state, though no deaths have been reported so far.

National Highway 54 remained blocked by a massive landslide near Bualte village in Lunglei district, leaving several tourists stranded for four days. The landslide has also cut off Lawngtlai and Siaha districts from the rest of the state. The Aizawl-Thenzawl-Lunglei highway has also been blocked due to major rockfalls near Ngazel on the southern outskirts of Aizawl.

In neighbouring Tripura, floods triggered by heavy rainfall over the past few days damaged more than 4,000 houses and forced nearly

11,000 people into relief camps. Officials said no deaths had been reported. Arunachal Pradesh reported fresh floods and landslides in West Kameng, Upper Subansiri and Tirap districts, damaging homes, roads and agricultural land. The recovery of a missing woman's body in Papum Pare district pushed the state's flood-related death toll to seven.

In Assam, disaster management authorities urged residents to remain cautious after the IMD forecast widespread rainfall across the state, including Guwahati, over the next few days. Officials warned of possible waterlogging, flash floods, traffic disruptions and localised landslides in vulnerable areas.

In Uttar Pradesh, heavy rainfall claimed more lives as different districts reported fatal incidents. A 28-year-old man died after allegedly falling into a roadside drain filled with rainwater while heading to work in Noida's Sector 58. In Muzaffarnagar, a 60-year-old woman was killed and her husband injured when their mud house collapsed. A 21-year-old farmer died after being struck by lightning while working in a paddy field in Balrampur.

The state also recorded intense rainfall. Mawana in Meerut district received 315 mm of rain in the 24 hours ending at 8.30 am, the highest in Uttar Pradesh, followed by Jansath in Muzaffarnagar with 270.1 mm. The IMD attributed the active monsoon conditions to an upper-air cyclonic circulation over central Uttar Pradesh and a well-marked low-pressure area over north-west Madhya Pradesh. An orange alert remains in force till July 11, with heavy to very heavy rainfall expected at many places.

In West Bengal, heavy showers disrupted daily life, especially in Kolkata, where waterlogging slowed traffic in several areas, including the IT hub of Sector V in Salt Lake. Schoolchildren and office-goers faced long delays as rain continued through the morning. Cooch Behar recorded the state's highest rainfall at 143 mm during the 24-hour period ending Friday morning, while Dum Dum, home to Kolkata airport, received 96 mm.

Delhi, however, witnessed clear skies after two days of persistent rain. Weather experts said the capital is likely to remain largely dry and warmer until July 15. Skymet Weather vice president Mahesh Palawat said rainfall activity would stay subdued because the monsoon trough has shifted towards the Himalayan foothills. Rajasthan is also expected to see weaker monsoon conditions for about a week, with mostly dry weather and only isolated light showers.

The IMD said fairly widespread to widespread rainfall is likely across Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura between July 10 and July 16, while rainfall activity is expected to remain subdued over central and south Peninsular India during the next six to seven days.

Elsewhere, light to moderate rain continued in parts of Haryana, Punjab and Chandigarh, keeping daytime temperatures below normal. Rail services on the Mumbai-Pune corridor will remain disrupted until July 17 after landslides triggered by torrential rain on July 6 damaged the Bhor Ghat section between Karjat and Lonavala, forcing the Central Railway to cancel 30 long-distance and intercity trains. In Kerala, one more body was recovered from the Wayanad landslide site, taking the death toll in the disaster to seven.

CJI during SC

any action against him. The court also found no reason to interfere with the Allahabad High Court's order, stating that after examining the records, it found “no good ground to interfere with the impugned judgment.” The appeal was accordingly dismissed.

Rajpal Yadav

be adjusted against the amount payable.

In its 108-page judgment, the court said Yadav repeatedly failed to honour undertakings to repay the complainant, M/s Murali Projects Pvt Ltd, despite several opportunities to settle the dispute. It noted that after the hearing concluded, the actor told the court he “was not willing to pay any amount to the complainant and would rather go to jail five times than return the money.”

The court observed, “Law is not a script that can be rewritten at the will of an actor, nor can legal positions be altered with every change of strategy.”

Rejecting Yadav's plea for release on probation, the court held there was no flaw in the lower court's sentencing order. It directed that Rs 1.04 crore from the fine in each case be paid to the complainant and Rs 25,000 to the state. In case of default, Yadav will have to undergo an additional six months' simple imprisonment in each case.

The court also ordered Yadav's wife, Radha Rajpal Yadav, to pay about Rs 5.5 lakh as fine to the complainant in each case, failing which she will undergo three months' simple imprisonment.

The dispute dates back to financial assistance of Rs 5 crore allegedly extended in 2010 for a film project. According to the complainant, Yadav issued seven cheques of Rs 1.05 crore each in 2013, but all were dishonoured. Under a 2012 agreement, Yadav, his wife and their company had agreed to repay nearly Rs 11 crore, including interest.

The revision petitions challenged a 2019 sessions court order affirming the magistrate's 2018 conviction. Yadav argued that incorrect legal advice led to the delay in filing the petitions and that he believed the conviction had already been challenged. The High Court rejected the explanation, saying he had access to experienced lawyers throughout and could not reasonably claim such a misconception for over five years.

Shekhar Suman

Act (FEMA) investigation into alleged violations involving export proceeds, undisclosed foreign assets and overseas bank accounts. The agency said its probe found that export earnings due to be brought back to India remained unrealised for a long period, while evidence also pointed to undisclosed overseas business interests and financial transactions.

The searches were carried out on July 9 under the provisions of FEMA, 1999, as part of an ongoing investigation into Kalanee Impex and Sangani.

According to the ED, export proceeds from certain overseas buyers were not realised despite the passage of considerable time. It said no extension for the pre-

scribed period had been obtained from the authorised dealer bank and there was no documented effort to recover the pending payments from the buyers.

Investigators also found that, in several cases, export proceeds were received from third-party entities instead of the overseas buyers or consignees mentioned in the export invoices and shipping bills, raising further questions over the transactions.

During the searches, the agency claimed to have uncovered evidence of undisclosed foreign assets and bank accounts linked to Sangani. It said he held a substantial stake in an undisclosed Canadian company and that the associated foreign bank account and related transactions had not been disclosed to the competent authorities. The ED also identified an undisclosed business entity in the United Arab Emirates.

So far, the agency has traced undisclosed bank accounts in Canada, the United States and the UAE. It is examining whether these assets and transactions violated FEMA provisions.

The ED further alleged that Sangani attempted to destroy digital evidence when its officers arrived to conduct the searches by throwing his mobile phone from the 13th floor of a building. A complaint was lodged with the Mumbai Police, following which the device was retrieved and seized by ED officials.

Officials said customs authorities in the US are examining certain transactions linked to Sangani, while authorities in the UK are also looking into related dealings. They also referred to a 2016 case in which the UK Border Force allegedly seized around 7.4 kg of under-declared gold jewellery being brought into the country by Sangani.

The ED said it is investigating possible FEMA violations arising from these transactions. Further investigation in the case is underway.

Govt mandates

from some state governments over the misuse of such products.

“The amendment is expected to strengthen regulatory oversight over those medicinal products containing alcohol, ensuring their supply only through the regulated pharmaceutical supply chain,” the ministry said. It added that the move would “significantly reduce the possibility of diversion and misuse while ensuring their continued availability for legitimate therapeutic use.”

Sources said the existing exemption had been misused in some parts of the country, allowing products containing cardamom, ginger and other spices to bypass prescribed alcohol limits despite being sold as medicinal preparations.

The changes are aimed at creating a uniform regulatory framework for medicines containing ethyl alcohol. Existing rules already cap alcohol content at 16 per cent for Ayurvedic, Siddha and Unani syrups under Rule 161 and at 12 per cent for Homeopathic medicines under Rule 106B.

The ministry said the amendment supports the government's efforts to strengthen drug regulation, encourage responsible use of medicinal products and safeguard public health. A detailed gazette notification has been published on the ministry's website.

CEO POST TO BE CREATED THROUGH BYLAW CHANGES

Ram Mandir Trust eyes corporate-style management

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust is set to introduce sweeping administrative reforms, including amendments to its bylaws to create the post of a Chief Executive Officer (CEO), as it seeks to professionalise the management of the Ram Temple in the wake of the donation theft controversy.

The proposed amendments, which will be placed before the trust's executive committee on July 22, are aimed at strengthening accountability, streamlining administration and introducing a corporate-style governance model.

Along with the bylaw changes, the meeting is also expected to consider the appointment of new trustees to fill vacant positions.

Trust Treasurer Govind Dev Giri has held discussions with senior Supreme



Court advocate and trustee K Parasaran, who drafted the trust's original bylaws when it was constituted in February 2020, regarding the proposed amendments. According to trust sources, Parasaran has already begun incorporating the necessary changes to facilitate the appointment of a CEO and restructure the trust's administrative and financial framework.

"The trust's bylaws have to be amended for appointing a Chief Executive Officer and bringing in administrative and financial reforms," a senior trust office-bearer said. "The trust is reviewing its administrative and financial framework after the SIT's preliminary findings exposed serious procedural lapses in the cash-counting system. The objective is to strengthen

accountability, tighten oversight and prevent any recurrence of such incidents."

The trust has decided against appointing a serving IAS officer as CEO, preferring instead a retired IAS officer or an individual with equivalent administrative experience.

Trust functionaries said a serving bureaucrat could create the perception that the temple's administration was under government control, whereas the trust intends to preserve its independent character.

A three-member committee has been asked to submit a panel of three names for the CEO's post before the July 22 meeting.

The committee will also recommend the CEO's powers, reporting structure and responsibilities.

The trust plans to run the Ram Temple on the lines of a professionally managed multinational organisation.

Datia by-poll ticket sparks revolt in MP BJP; district chief quits, workers block highway

BJP workers and supporters of Narottam Mishra demand change in candidate after BJP fields Ashutosh Tiwari; more resignations threatened as protests continue

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: The BJP faced a major internal revolt in Madhya Pradesh on Friday after senior leader and former state Home minister Narottam Mishra was denied the party ticket for the Datia Assembly by-election.

The party instead nominated Ashutosh Tiwari, triggering widespread protests and resignations by district BJP leaders.

Thousands of BJP workers took to the roads in Datia, blocked a national highway and staged demonstrations, demanding that the party withdraw Tiwari's candidature and field Mishra instead.

Protesters raised slogans against the party's decision, bringing traffic to a standstill for some time.

Escalating the rebellion, BJP's Datia district president Raghuvver Singh Kushwaha



resigned from his post in protest against the ticket allocation. Several district office-bearers also tendered their resignations, while BJP councillors, block presidents and other local leaders warned that they would step down if the party failed to replace Tiwari with Mishra as its candidate.

Party workers maintained that Mishra, a prominent BJP face in the Gwalior-Chambal region and a former minister, remained the most acceptable candidate for the constituency.

They urged the central leadership to reconsider its decision before the election campaign gathers momentum.

As this report was filed, protests were continuing in Datia, with agitating BJP workers insisting that the party revise its choice of candidate.

The developments have exposed rare public dissent within the BJP in Madhya Pradesh ahead of the crucial by-election.

The Datia by-poll was necessitated after the Madhya

Pradesh Assembly disqualified Congress MLA Rajendra Bharti following his conviction by a Delhi court in a bank fraud case. Bharti was sentenced to three years' imprisonment, resulting in the vacancy.

The by-poll is scheduled for July 30, with July 13 being the last date for filing nominations. Bharti had defeated Narottam Mishra in the 2023 Assembly election from Datia.

In the run-up to the by-poll, Mishra had actively campaigned in the constituency, purchased nomination papers and held several public meetings, including appeals to voters to forgive him for past controversies.

Given his sustained outreach and his long association with the constituency, he was widely expected to be renominated by the BJP to reclaim the seat he had represented for multiple terms.

'NOT A MODI BREAKTHROUGH'

Australia's ruling party approved uranium sales to India in 2011: Cong

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Friday slammed the BJP for projecting that Australia's uranium sales to India are Prime Minister Narendra Modi's breakthrough and pointed out that in December 2011, then Australian Prime Minister Julia Gillard got the approval of her party to sell uranium to India following the Indo-US Nuclear pact.

The Opposition party's assertion came after BJP IT department head Amit Malviya said that in 2010, Australia refused to sell uranium to India, but under Modi's leadership, the two countries have struck a uranium export agreement.

Rejecting the BJP's assertions, Congress general secre-

'The BJP trolls that include some of its MPs too need to do their homework better'

tary Jairam Ramesh said, "The BJP ecosystem is on an overdrive to show that Australia's uranium sales to India are a Modi breakthrough. On Dec 4 2011, Australian Prime Minister Julia Gillard got approval of her party to sell uranium to India following the India-US Nuclear Agreement of Oct 2008."

"The BJP trolls that include some of its MPs too need to do their homework better," he said and shared a screenshot of

media reports from December 2011 that stated that Australia's Labour Party had endorsed plans to open up uranium sales to India.

Earlier, Malviya said, "In 2010, Australia refused to sell uranium to India, citing our non-signatory status to the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT). Today, under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, India and Australia have struck a uranium export agreement."

"This isn't just about uranium. It reflects India's transformed global standing. From being viewed through the prism of restrictions to being treated as a trusted strategic partner," Malviya said on X.

'One nation, one election' mechanism may be ready for rollout by 2029: Joint panel chief

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Closer Look

» PP Chaudhary claimed that nearly 99 per cent of civil society stakeholders consulted so far have backed the proposal

» An overwhelming majority of those consulted have supported the idea of simultaneous elections, said the BJP MP from Pali in Rajasthan

Bill, 2024, with an interaction with Chief Minister Pramod Sawant and members of his Cabinet, seeking their views on the challenges involved in implementing simultaneous elections and ways to address them.

"We had an informal interaction with the chief minister and Cabinet ministers, who represent the people of Goa. We discussed how 'One Nation, One Election' can be implemented, what challenges exist and how they can

be mitigated while maintaining a fine balance acceptable to all," Chaudhary said.

He said that the committee has visited several states, including Gujarat, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Haryana and Delhi, where it interacted with constitutional experts, civil society organisations, educationists and other stakeholders.

An overwhelming majority of those consulted have sup-

ported the idea of simultaneous elections, said the BJP MP from Pali in Rajasthan.

"We have found that almost 99 per cent of stakeholders, particularly from civil society and various organisations, favour simultaneous elections. The effort now is to evolve a mechanism that is acceptable to all political parties," he said.

Asked about the timeline for implementation, he said the committee was examining various options, indicating that the reform could become operational by the time the next general elections are due in 2029.

He said there is also a possibility of bringing some states into alignment before that if political parties and the chief ministers voluntarily agree to synchronise their electoral cycles.

ENERGY BOOST FOR 'DOUBLE-ENGINE' BENGAL

Power play: Kolkata lands India Energy Week

Prime Minister Narendra Modi scheduled to inaugurate the four-day summit

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Centre has chosen Kolkata to host the fifth edition of India Energy Week (IEW) from January 28 to 31, 2027, marking the flagship energy summit's debut in West Bengal after the Suvendu Adhikari-led government assumed office.

The decision underscores the state's strategic importance as India's eastern energy gateway, anchored by the Haldia Refinery and Petrochemical Complex, major ports and connectivity to the Northeast as well as Bangladesh, Nepal and Bhutan. The flagship annual event of the Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas will be held in West Bengal for the first time after four successive editions in Bengaluru and Goa. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is scheduled to inaugurate the four-day summit, which will



be hosted across the Biswa Bangla Convention Centre, Biswa Bangla Mela Prangan, WBTPO and Eco Park.

Beyond its strategic location, West Bengal is emerging as an important player in both conventional and clean energy value chains. The state government is focusing on offshore wind research in the Bay of Bengal, green hydrogen prospects near Haldia, renewable energy integration, biofuels and clean industrial energy. The

Takeaways

- » Bengal is also home to several energy-intensive industries, including steel, cement, chemicals, petrochemicals, engineering and tea processing
- » The 2026 edition featured 11 country pavilions, including the United States, the United Kingdom, Germany, Japan, Russia and China

summit is expected to enhance the state's visibility among global investors and energy companies.

Bengal is also home to several energy-intensive industries, including steel, cement, chemicals, petrochemicals, engineering and tea processing. With New Delhi sharpening its focus on energy security and eastern connectivity under the Act East Policy, the state's role in India's energy sector is expected to grow further.

Launched in February 2023 as part of India's G20 presidency,

India Energy Week has emerged as the country's premier global energy platform, bringing together policymakers, industry leaders, financiers, technology providers and researchers. A key feature is the CEO Roundtable, where global energy chiefs engage with Indian public sector undertakings and private sector leaders.

The summit comes at a critical juncture for the global energy sector, with discussions expected to centre on energy security, sustainability and the clean energy tran-

sition amid geopolitical tensions, investment uncertainties and pressing decarbonisation goals. Deliberations are also likely to focus on balancing energy security with practical transition pathways while creating stable investment environments to drive innovation and growth.

The 2026 edition featured 11 country pavilions, including the United States, the United Kingdom, Germany, Japan, Russia and China. Ministers and deputy ministers from the UAE, Canada, Oman, the Netherlands and Russia also attended, alongside representatives of international organisations such as the International Energy Forum (IEF) and BIMSTEC.

The conference will feature ministerial sessions, leadership panels and bilateral meetings on global energy priorities and India's expanding role in the sector.

'Become an expert mother before an IAS Officer': UP Governor tells women graduates

Patel says building strong families is as important as building successful careers

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: The Madras High Court on Friday restrained the EC till July 31 from notifying bye-polls to the five constituencies in Tamil Nadu where the winning candidates resigned soon after getting elected in the Assembly polls held on April 23 this year.

The five segments includes Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay's Tiruchirappalli (East) Assembly constituency.

The First Bench comprising Chief Justice S A Dharmadhikari and Justice G Arulmurugan passed the interim order and posted to July 31, further hearing of a Public Interest Litigation filed by advocate K Venkatachalapathy.

KANPUR: Uttar Pradesh Governor Anandiben Patel on Friday urged young women to become "expert mothers" before aspiring to become IAS officers or teachers, saying that building strong families is as important as building successful careers.

Addressing the 41st convocation of Chhatrapati Shahu Ji Maharaj University (CSJMU) in Kanpur, Patel said professional success should go hand in hand with the ability to nurture a family. "Whether you become an IAS officer or a teacher, first become an expert mother. Everyone should know how to cook the food prepared at home," the Governor told graduating students.

Expanding on the theme, Patel said education should not merely produce degree holders but individuals capable of fulfilling their responsibilities towards society



Uttar Pradesh Governor Anandiben Patel during the convocation ceremony of Harcourt Butler Technical University, in Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh, Friday

and their families. She stressed that professional competence and social responsibility must go together if education is to serve its true purpose.

Calling upon young women to prepare themselves for family life alongside pursuing careers, Patel said motherhood and nurturing a family require as much dedica-

tion, knowledge and commitment as any profession. She also encouraged women not to discontinue their education after marriage, saying their learning and skills should continue to contribute to nation building.

The Governor said the responsibility of parents does not end once their children secure admission

Key Points

- » Patel said professional success should go hand in hand with the ability to nurture a family
- » Patel also expressed concern over the growing incidence of domestic violence and crimes against women

to schools or colleges. They must remain actively involved in their children's lives and monitor their activities, as even a small lapse in supervision could adversely affect their future.

Patel also expressed concern over the growing incidence of domestic violence and crimes against women, saying the rise in such offences raises questions about the quality of education being imparted.

Over 93.95 cr Ayushman Bharat accounts created: Health ministry

NEW DELHI: The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) has emerged as one of the world's largest digital health ecosystems, with over 93.95 crore accounts created, 105 crore health records linked, and 5.33 lakh health facilities and 9.85 lakh healthcare professionals registered on the national digital health registries, the Union health

ministry said on Friday.

The initiative has also enabled 2.72 lakh healthcare facilities to adopt ABDM-enabled software, generating around 24 crore scan and register tokens for faster OPD registration and facilitating seamless, consent-based exchange of health information across the healthcare sector, according to an official statement.

ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण		
खाल संख्या-1, नौएडा पार्क-IV, ग्रेटर नौएडा सिटी, गंगासुन्दर गार्ड-201308, उ.प्र. वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in ई-मेल: authority@gnida.in		
पत्रांक: वरि. प्र./ई-निविदा सेल/2026/778	दिनांक: 10.07.2026	
ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना		
महाप्रबन्धक (अभियन्त्रण) ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यालयक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नौएडा की ओर से ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-वरि. प्र./ (ई-निविदा सेल)/2026/777 दिनांक 10.07.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम संख्या-01 से 12 तक के कार्य की ई-निविदाये आमन्त्रित जाती है। समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नौएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.greaternoidaauthority.in पर ई-निविदा लिंक एवं ई-पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।		
क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम / वर्क सॉकिल	अनुमानित लागत
निर्माण का कार्य		
1.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर ओमीकॉन 1ए में बाउण्ड्रीवॉल की मरम्मत एवं कॉईल फोसिंग उपलब्ध कराने एवं लगाने का कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-6)	रु. 21.02 लाख
2.	ग्राम मिलक लक्ष्मी, रोजा जलालपुर, रोजा याकूपपुर एवं अछेजा में तीन वर्ष तक मरम्मत का कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-1)	रु. 78.88 लाख
3.	ग्रेटर नौएडा टेकजॉन-4 में राइज पुलिस चौकी से अंडरपास तक आर.सी.सी नाली, सेंट्रल वर्ज का निर्माण एवं प्रीकास्ट ड्रेन कवरिंग स्लैब लगाना एवं फिक्स कराने का कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-3)	रु. 454.32 लाख
4.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर म्यू-2 में (40.0 वर्ग मीटर के फ्लैटों) में विविध सिविल कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-6)	रु. 506.46 लाख
5.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर-16 (आवासीय और औद्योगिक), सैक्टर-16 बी, सैक्टर-4, सैक्टर इकोटेक-12 और सैक्टर टेकजॉन-7 में विभिन्न स्थानों पर प्रीकास्ट ड्रेन कवर लगाना और बिछाना का कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-1)	रु. 659.38 लाख
6.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर म्यू-2 में (29.76 वर्ग मीटर के फ्लैटों) में विविध सिविल कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-6)	रु. 762.49 लाख
7.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर म्यू-2 में (40.0 वर्ग मीटर के फ्लैटों) में आंतरिक आरसीसी नाली का निर्माण कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-6)	रु. 1170.67 लाख
8.	ग्रेटर नौएडा की 105 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क से ओमिकॉन 1ए के टी-पॉइंट तक 60 मीटर सड़क पर इण्टरलॉकिंग ट्राईएल, ग्रास पेवर, आर.सी.सी. सुखा दीवार एवं म्यू रोटररी से ओमिकॉन 1ए के टी-पॉइंट तक 60 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क का चौड़ीकरण का कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-6)	रु. 1883.64 लाख
9.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर जू-3 के साथ स्थित 130 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क (बादा रोटररी) से डीएमआईसी रोड तक 60 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क का पूर्णतः पुटपाथ बिछाने, चौड़ीकरण एवं सुदृढीकरण और आर.सी.सी सुखा दीवार और नाली का निर्माण कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-6)	रु. 2563.63 लाख
जलापूर्ति एवं सीवर के कार्य		
10.	ग्रेटर नौएडा में सैक्टर-12ए में गंगाजल कैम्पस आर-17 की सड़क, ड्रेन, रन वाटर हारोस्टिंग, टॉयलेट, गार्ड रूम एवं बाउंड्रीवाल का निर्माण कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल - जल)	रु. 58.20 लाख
वार्षिक अनुरक्षण		
11.	ग्रेटर नौएडा में मनोता कट से भारत पेट्रोल पम्प (तिलपता रोटररी के ओर यू-टर्न) तक 130 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क का तीन साल के लिए (ड्रेन सफाई, जंगल सफाई, कर्व स्टेनो की मरम्मत, सीडिंग रोड मार्किंग और अन्य विविध कार्य) रखरखाव/अनुरक्षण कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-7)	रु. 148.11 लाख
उद्यान विभाग		
12.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के जीएमआईसीए कार्यालय में एक वर्ष के रखरखाव सहित वॉटिकल गार्डन की स्थापना और उसे लगाने का कार्य। (वर्क सॉकिल-उद्यान)	रु. 28.48 लाख

क्रम सं-01, 02, 10, 11, एवं 12 तक के कार्यों को दिनांक-15.07.2026 से 27.07.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 27.07.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जाएगी, एवं क्रम सं-03, 04, 05, 06, 07, 08 एवं 09 तक के कार्यों को दिनांक-15.07.2026 से 28.07.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 30.07.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जाएगी।

वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक(ई-निविदा सेल)
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'HUNGER HAS STABILISED'

On day 13 of indefinite fast, Wangchuk warns against forced removal

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Educator and climate activist Sonam Wangchuk on Friday said his hunger had "stabilised" as he entered the 13th day of his indefinite fast and asserted that his constitutional right should not be violated by attempting to remove him from the protest site.

He has been fasting in support of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) agitation at Jantar Mantar, demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation and government accountability over alleged examination irregularities, which entered its 21st day. "Today is the 13th day (of the fast). I am feeling okay. My hunger has stabilised. The initial days are difficult as the body adjusts to fasting. There is some tiredness, but otherwise I am fine," Wangchuk told reporters. He said he has lost muscle along with fat during the prolonged fast but continues to feel energetic.

"I have lost muscle along with fat. My bones are beginning to show, but I still feel energetic," he said.

Asked about the possibility of the administration intervening if his health deteriorated, Wangchuk said he was at the protest site voluntarily and there was no reason for the authorities to remove him.

"I don't know why they should try to remove me. I am here willingly and there is no threat to my life. If they remove me, it will be a violation of our rights," he said. "We are holding a peaceful protest. The country and the world are watching the state of our democracy. This is not a favour. It is our right. We have the right to hold a peace-



Sonam Wangchuk during his indefinite hunger strike on Friday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Wangchuk entered the 13th day of his indefinite fast
- » He asserted that his constitutional right should not be violated by attempting to remove him

ful protest under Article 19, and I hope that right continues to be respected," he added.

Wangchuk said he was continuing the fast in support of students seeking accountability over alleged examination irregularities as well as to press for an early resolution of issues concerning Ladakh.

"I am standing here in support of the students, for accountability in issues related to education. The issue of Ladakh has also progressed through talks, and now it should be brought to a conclusion. The Monsoon Session is a very good time to finalise it," he said.

Referring to the student suicides -- allegedly linked to the NEET-UG cancellation in May -- Wangchuk said the protest aimed to ensure that such inci-

dents were not repeated.

"As you know, 20 students have committed suicide. It should not happen that next year the number rises to 40 or 80. We are sitting here to prevent such situations," he said.

He also said accepting Pradhan's resignation before the Monsoon Session would help the government regain the confidence of young people.

"If they accept the education minister's resignation, they may become popular among the youth again. Right now there is a lot of anger among young people, which will harm them politically. They should do it for their own benefit before Parliament meets. If they don't, we will do whatever else we have to do," he said.

CJP spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka said Wangchuk has lost about 7.5 kg since beginning the fast and that his blood sugar levels remain consistently low.

"As the days go by, his energy is decreasing. He has considerable weakness while walking and finds it difficult to speak. It is a deteriorating situation. Our medical team is closely monitoring him, and we hope the government will listen to us soon," Ranka said.

EFFORTS TO STRENGTHEN MARITIME & COASTAL SECURITY

HM Amit Shah directs ports to engage only licensed private security agencies

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Friday directed that only licensed private security agencies be engaged at ports and that personnel trained by the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) be given priority, as the government moves to strengthen the country's maritime and coastal security framework.

Chairing a high-level review meeting on the proposed Bureau of Port Security along with Union Ports, Shipping and Waterways Minister Sarbananda Sonowal, Shah also called for container scanning facilities at all ports under the proposed bureau's surveillance and ordered trial runs of the new security mechanism at major ports.

The meeting was attended by the Home Secretary, Intelligence Bureau Director, secretaries of the Ministries of Border Management, Ports,



Home Minister Amit Shah and Ports, Shipping and Waterways Minister Sarbananda Sonowal hold a review meeting regarding the progress made in establishing the Bureau of Port Security, in New Delhi PTI

Shipping and Waterways and Fisheries, the CISF Director General and other senior officials. The Home Minister directed authorities to prepare the curriculum for the proposed Port Security Training Institute and expedite training programmes by utilising existing infrastructure of other agencies. He also asked the Home Ministry, Defence Ministry and other departments

to maintain a comprehensive database of all security personnel working under the proposed Bureau of Port Security.

The proposed Bureau of Port Security will be established as a statutory body under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways and governed by the Merchant Shipping Act, 2025. It will be responsible for regulation, policy, legal matters and surveillance related to the secu-

TAKEAWAYS

- » Shah was chairing a high-level review meeting on the proposed Bureau of Port Security along with Union Shipping Minister Sarbananda Sonowal
- » Shah called for container scanning facilities at all ports under the proposed bureau's surveillance

Haryana CM inaugurates Mango Mela in Pinjore

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday inaugurated the three-day 33rd Mango Mela at the historic Yadavindra Gardens in Pinjore and said the country's vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047 would be realised through the strength of its farmlands.

Addressing the gathering, Saini said farmers must move beyond being mere producers and become value creators and exporters. He said farmers' incomes would rise significantly when Haryana's mangoes reach supermarkets in global cities such as London, New York, Dubai and Tokyo.

Welcoming progressive farmers, horticulturists, entrepreneurs and tourists from across the country, the Chief Minister said the display of more than 200 varieties of mangoes reflected the innovation, experience and hard work of the farming community. MPOST

NDA cadet dies post 1st physical training parade

PUNE: A first-term cadet of the Pune-based National Defence Academy (NDA) complained of uneasiness during routine physical training on Friday morning and later died, the defence PRO office here said.

Cadet Abhinav Bajpai (17), a native of Kanpur in Uttar Pradesh, joined the prestigious tri-services training institute at Khadakwasla near Pune city on June 24, 2026.

During the routine morning physical training session, following the first official PT parade after joining the academy, he complained of uneasiness and suddenly became unconscious, said a release issued by the office of Defence

Public Relations Officer (PRO).

The cadet was immediately shifted to the Military Hospital, Khadakwasla, where intensive resuscitative efforts were undertaken by a medical team. Despite dedicated efforts, the cadet could not be revived and was declared dead, said the release.

A Court of Inquiry (CoI) has been ordered to ascertain the facts and circumstances leading to the incident and the next of kin of the deceased cadet and police have been informed, it said.

"The National Defence Academy extends deepest condolences to the bereaved family during this difficult time," the release added. AGENCIES

CM Saini sets deadline to make Panchkula Haryana's 'best city'

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday directed officials to install recharge wells in every park in Panchkula to prevent waterlogging during the monsoon and ensure that only treated water is used for irrigating parks.

Chairing the fourth meeting of the Panchkula Metropolitan Development Authority (PMDA) in Chandigarh, which lasted for nearly three hours, the Chief Minister reviewed ongoing projects and approved future development plans for the city. Stating that the government's aim is to make Panchkula the number one city in



Haryana, Saini asked officials to prepare a comprehensive, time-bound action plan to achieve the objective.

Reviewing the Multi-Feature Park project, officials informed the CM that around Rs 22 crore had already been spent on it. Taking serious note, Saini ordered an inquiry and sought a detailed report. He directed officials to

develop major parks with ornamental plantations, restored water bodies, fountains and adequate public toilet facilities. The Chief Minister also called for making Panchkula a slum-free city by identifying suitable land and preparing a project for high-rise residential apartments for eligible families.

Ahead of the monsoon, Saini directed immediate cleaning of sewer lines and drains and stressed that sanitation, sewerage, roads and drinking water supply should receive top priority. He also ordered the transfer of three Super Sucker machines from HSVP to the Municipal Corporation. He said Atal Park would be completed by November 30.

CBI searches Mumbai, Kochi locations in Rs 133-cr bank fraud probe

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Friday conducted searches at multiple locations in Mumbai and Kochi in connection with an alleged bank fraud of Rs 133.52 crore involving Furnace Fabrica (India) Ltd.

The agency registered the case on July 9 on the basis of a complaint filed by the State Bank of India's Stressed Assets Management (SAM) Branch in Mumbai. According to the complaint, the accused entered into a criminal conspiracy to obtain enhanced credit facilities from the bank by furnishing false information and subsequently diverted the loan proceeds for purposes other than those for which they were sanctioned.

The FIR has been registered under relevant provisions of the Indian Penal Code and the Banking Regulation Act against A.R. Basheeruddin, Badri Prasad, Nezee Basheeruddin, Raiz Basheeruddin and Sanam Basheer, all directors of M/s Furnace Fabrica. The case also names certain unidentified public servants and private individuals.

According to the CBI, the accused allegedly misappropriated the bank funds, causing a wrongful loss of Rs 133.52 crore to SBI and corresponding gains to the company and its promoters. As part of the investigation, the agency carried out searches in Maharashtra and Kerala on July 10 and recovered documents and other incriminating material. The evidence is being examined to establish the modus operandi of the alleged fraud and trace the diversion and flow of funds.

"The CBI has so far gathered information indicating possible misappropriation of the loan funds by the accused," the agency said.

The investigation is continuing to ascertain the full extent of the conspiracy and identify the roles of all those involved, including unknown public servants. MPOST

IRS officer leads initiative to help rural India aspirants crack UPSC

SWATI MAHAJAN

CHANDIGARH: In an effort to bridge the information gap faced by civil services aspirants from rural India, a group of 15 civil servants has launched a non-profit digital initiative aimed at providing guidance, mentorship and career planning support to UPSC candidates.

The platform, Civil Services Margdarshan, has been founded by IRS officer Vikas Sangwan, currently serving as Commissioner of Income Tax. Launched on June 25, the portal has drawn significant interest from aspirants across the country within just 15 days.

Speaking to Millennium Post, Sangwan said the initiative is not a coaching institute but a digital platform designed



IRS officer Vikas Sangwan

to help talented students from villages prepare through self-study and proper guidance.

"All the members of this organisation come from rural backgrounds and have personally experienced the lack of mentorship and information during their preparation. We want to ensure that deserving candidates do not miss opportunities because of inadequate

guidance," he said.

Sharing his own journey, Sangwan said he was an engineering graduate working in a private company when a colleague encouraged him to prepare for the civil services examination.

Describing himself as a "below-average student", he said perseverance helped him overcome several personal challenges. During his preparation, his mother was diagnosed with cancer and he would accompany her to Delhi hospitals for treatment before studying late into the night. "There was a time when I thought of quitting, but my father advised me never to give up. That guidance changed my outlook and, with God's grace, I cleared the examination," he said.

UFSEC: UP showcases safety-first vision

Experts highlight necessity of ensuring safety & environmental sustainability

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI/ GREATER NOIDA: Safety and disaster preparedness have become important issues for India as the nation continues on its industrialisation and urbanisation path, which were the key topics discussed during the 5th edition of the largest exhibition and conference held by India on industrial safety, fire safety and disaster management, UFSEC 2026, starting at India Expo Centre & Mart in Greater Noida.

The event, which is being organised by PHD Chamber of Commerce & Industry (PHDCCI) in collaboration with Safety Appliances Manufacturers Association (SAMA), gathered key government representatives, policymakers, industry leaders and safety experts for discussion about ways of building the resilience of the industrial environment in India using technological advances, policy reforms and enhanced regulations.

As the state of Uttar Pradesh has been positioning itself as a fast-growing industrial and manufacturing centre in India, the discussion at



Dignitaries during the UFSEC 2026 MPOST

the conference emphasised the rising focus of the state on the development of advanced safety infrastructure and fire preparedness and disaster resilience in urban development. It was stated that the safety requirements will be critical for the state, as it continues receiving large investments within programs such as Invest UP.

IPS officer Kalpana Saxena delivered the keynote address, calling for a comprehensive strategy towards disaster preparedness, highlighting the necessity of ensuring safety and environmental sustainability

in the development agenda of the country. Additional District Magistrate Ajeet Kumar, Gautam Budh Nagar, highlighted the significance of strict enforcement of safety norms along with increased public awareness as the cities witness a phase of rapid redevelopment.

The conference witnessed some highly insightful deliberations on the subject of safety leadership in hazardous sectors as well as the significance of Industry 4.0 technologies in revolutionising the HSE practices in the oil and gas industry. The importance of utilising

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: Acknowledging the frequency of climate-induced disasters in Himachal Pradesh, Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Friday announced that the state would develop disaster-resilient infrastructure at an estimated cost of Rs 3,500 crore to strengthen its ability to withstand natural calamities and minimise losses.

Addressing the valedictory session of the high-level workshop on "Towards Resilience Infrastructure Planning in the Western Himalaya" at the Dr Manmohan Singh Himachal Pradesh Institute of Public Administration (HIPA) in Shimla, the Chief Minister said the hill state, owing to its difficult geographical conditions, had become increasingly vulnerable to natural disasters.

Recalling the devastating



HP CM Sukhvinder Sukhu addresses a session of a workshop at HIPA

disaster of 2023, Sukhu said nearly 75,000 tourists had been stranded across the state. The government, however, ensured their safe evacuation and restored essential services on a war footing. He particularly appreciated Revenue Minister Jagat Singh Negi and MLA Sanjay Awasthi for personally leading the rescue operation that evacuated around 300 stranded tourists from Chandratla Lake. The Chief Minister said

the 2023 disaster had damaged around 23,000 houses and claimed 51 lives. Standing firmly with the affected families, the government introduced major changes in the relief policy by increasing compensation for fully damaged houses from Rs 1.30 lakh to Rs 8 lakh.

He said the lessons learnt from the 2023 tragedy had enabled the government to respond more effectively during the 2025 disaster, resulting

Himachal govt transfers 17 IAS officers

SHIMLA: In a major administrative re-shuffle, the Himachal Pradesh government on Friday transferred 17 IAS officers and 22 HPAS officers.

Onkar Chand Sharma, who is serving as Additional Chief Secretary (Tribal Development), has been given the additional charge of the Transport Department. IAS officer Rawther Dawood Nazeem has been appointed Additional Chief Secretary (Home and Vigilance, MPP and Power), relieving Chief Secretary Kamlesh Kumar Pant of the additional charge of Home and Vigilance. Devesh Kumar will continue as Principal Secretary for Finance, Planning, Economics and Statistics, and PWD, with additional charge of the Animal Husbandry Department. M Sudha Devi has been posted as Principal Secretary (Forest and Industries) and will continue to hold the additional charge of the Personnel Department.

Ashish Singhmar has been entrusted with the additional responsibility of Secretary (Health and Family Welfare) while retaining his existing portfolios. MPOST

SRINAGAR MOB VIOLENCE NIA files chargesheet against six Hurriyat leaders in 1996 case

NEW DELHI: The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has filed a chargesheet against six senior Hurriyat Conference leaders in connection with a 1996 case involving mob violence, instigation and firing at police personnel during a funeral procession in Srinagar.

The chargesheet was filed before a special court in Jammu against Shabir Ahmad Beigh, Syed Ali Shah Geelani, Abdul Ganie Lone, Mohamammad Yaqoob Wakeel alias Mohammad Yaqoob Vakili, Javid Ahmad Mir and Shakeel Ahmad Bakshi. They have been charged under various provisions of the erstwhile Ranbir Penal Code, including criminal conspiracy, attempt to murder, rioting and assault on public servants, along with Section 13 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967.

The NIA said proceedings against Geelani, Lone and Wakeel have been closed following their deaths, though the investigation found sufficient evidence of their involvement

in the alleged conspiracy and unlawful assembly.

The case relates to violence that broke out at NAZ Crossing in Srinagar on July 17, 1996, during the funeral procession of slain terrorist Hilal Ahmad Beigh. According to the agency, the accused led the procession and allegedly instigated the mob, which included terrorists who opened indiscriminate fire at security personnel, injuring several policemen. The mob also allegedly pelted stones at government vehicles.

The investigation further found that anti-India and pro-Pakistan slogans were raised and speeches were delivered advocating armed struggle. The NIA alleged that separatists and terrorists used the funeral procession to incite violence and create unrest to promote their ideology of the dismemberment of India.

The case was transferred to the NIA by the Ministry of Home Affairs in April 2026. Further investigation is continuing. MPOST

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EDITORIAL

A FRAGILE
FRAMEWORK

Diplomacy often begins with agreements, but lasting peace depends on whether societies can sustain them. Lebanon's latest US-brokered framework with Israel has highlighted this reality. While presented as a step towards ending decades of conflict, it has instead exposed Lebanon's deep political divisions and the weakness of state institutions after years of economic crisis and instability. The central challenge extends beyond Israeli troop withdrawal or Hezbollah's disarmament. It lies in whether Lebanon possesses the political consensus and institutional capacity to transform a ceasefire into a durable peace. Without that foundation, the agreement risks becoming another temporary arrangement rather than a lasting solution.

Lebanon's internal politics have long been shaped by regional rivalries involving Iran, Israel, the United States and several Arab countries. Hezbollah, which emerged during Israel's occupation of southern Lebanon in the 1980s, has evolved into both a powerful political force and an armed organisation operating outside the full control of the Lebanese state. Supporters regard its military capabilities as essential for national defence against Israel, while critics argue that a sovereign democratic state cannot function when armed groups exist beyond state authority. These competing perspectives remain at the heart of Lebanon's political debate and complicate any effort to achieve national unity.

The proposed framework reflects these competing interests. It links a complete Israeli withdrawal to Hezbollah's disarmament, a sequence viewed by many as necessary for restoring state sovereignty. Yet many Lebanese question an arrangement that appears to delay Israeli withdrawal while requiring immediate concessions from Hezbollah. Israel argues that security guarantees are essential before leaving southern Lebanon, citing repeated cross-border violence. Hezbollah rejects the proposal as unbalanced, while the Lebanese government faces the difficult task of strengthening state authority without provoking internal instability. The dispute therefore extends beyond diplomacy and touches the country's constitutional order, national identity and political future.

Lebanon's history offers strong reasons for caution. The civil war between 1975 and 1990, followed by later episodes of political violence, demonstrated how quickly disagreements can escalate when institutions are weak and trust is absent. Today, economic collapse, unemployment and declining public confidence have further undermined governance. Under such conditions, diplomatic agreements alone cannot deliver stability. Peace requires functioning institutions, economic recovery and political dialogue that addresses the concerns of all communities rather than serving external geopolitical interests.

Lebanon's future also remains closely tied to wider regional dynamics. Relations among Iran, Israel and the United States will continue to influence the country's stability. While international mediation and reconstruction support remain important, lasting peace can only emerge through broad Lebanese consensus. The country's experience reinforces a wider lesson for the Middle East: ceasefires may reduce immediate violence, but they cannot replace political reconciliation. Sustainable peace depends upon legitimate institutions, respect for sovereignty, protection of civilians and inclusive political processes. Lebanon now stands at a critical crossroads, where the success of any diplomatic framework will depend not only on international negotiations but also on the willingness of domestic and regional actors to place dialogue above confrontation.

ENERGY TRANSITION

Powering a Greener Future

Coal will remain central to India's energy security for years, making cleaner mining, efficient transportation and low-carbon technologies essential for sustainable growth



SUTRITHA BHATTACHARYA & DN PRASAD

Coal has been the fuel for power generation in India and many other countries for a long time. Now, with growing concern about the adverse carbon footprint of coal and the advent of technologies producing green power at lower cost, there is a clearly visible shift towards green energy. However, in India, coal may still continue to be the dominant energy source for some time. Carbon mitigation across the life cycle of coal production, associated transportation, and combustion is thus of significant importance.

Globally, mined coal is prepared through crushing, sizing, and washing before being supplied to consumers. In India, the direct dispatch of run-of-mine (ROM) coal without such preparation to generating plants has been a practice for years, dating back to the coal scarcity era. ROM coal needs to be replaced with prepared coal on priority to reduce emissions.

It is important to mandate the crushing, sizing, and washing of

coal and dispatch it through non-road modes of transport, which would leave a lower carbon footprint while minimising spillage, spoilage, and environmentally destructive impacts.

In place of only two commercial miners, Coal India and Singareni Collieries, today, thanks to reforms, coal can be commercially sourced from a large number of miners in both the public and private sectors, giving consumers the comfort of choice. Today, it is important for India to bet on a locally available and proven energy source like coal while making it more efficient from the perspectives of cost and pollution. The energy mix for a country like India, with the rapid development of data centres and strong growth in per capita consumption, cannot be fully dependent on green energy, including nuclear power, in the short or medium term. The recent energy crisis, which is yet to fully abate, is a stark reminder that energy security must remain a key national objective.

The challenge today is to make the cycle of coal production and its usage leave a smaller carbon footprint. A good way would be to encourage only plants located close to mines, under strict conditions to mitigate the impact of the concentration of such consuming plants. Power generated could then be distributed nationally through high-voltage transmission lines. With the emergence of nuclear power and a large num-



The challenge is no longer whether India uses coal, but how responsibly it produces and consumes it

ber of pumped storage projects enabling round-the-clock green power, coupled with battery and other storage systems, robust national and regional transmission networks need to be put in place at speed. Transmission constraints reportedly preventing the supply of green energy are a matter of grave concern.

The newly laid focus on coal gasification for producing coal-based fertilisers and chemicals needs to specifically incorporate

provisions for carbon capture mechanisms to make the integrated technology environmentally friendly.

For existing plants involving long-distance coal transportation, water routes have to be proactively explored. Large-scale barge transportation through rivers and ship transportation from port to port could be ideal methods that would reduce pollution while not adding significantly to the cost of fuel at the plant.

The Government of India has launched schemes such as Sagarmala, focusing on coastal shipping, and Gati Shakti, providing multimodal connectivity by optimising coal logistics from mines to power plants through coordinated planning of railway and road infrastructure. The Government of India is also providing significant financial outlays for the development of inland waterways, port logistics for handling bulk cargo, and carbon capture

initiatives. It is imperative that coal producers and consumers take full advantage of such schemes to meet their needs of maintaining the economic cost of production or power generation while reducing carbon footprints. A national task force under the Gati Shakti initiative could closely monitor progress and guide this transition.

Putting in place rules and policies mandating migration to modern mining practices, including coal preparation and transportation from mines only through coal handling plants, using less carbon-intensive modes of transport, and adopting High Efficiency Low Emission (HELE) technology for burning coal in power plants would be necessary for the long-term sustainability of coal and its end-use sectors. A carbon credit mechanism should be proactively explored to bring financial incentives to those delivering better environmental performance.

We hope that by developing green power at what may be called the gold-standard Indian pace and promoting less carbon-intensive coal and its uses in the ways suggested, India will be able to truly establish itself as a green energy and green data destination.

Views expressed are personal
S Bhattacharya is a retired IAS Officer and a former Chairman Coal India Limited; DN Prasad is Former Adviser, Ministry of Coal

AT VANTAGE

Tradition with Modernity

Naomi Osaka's Wimbledon kimono tribute is more than a fashion statement, as it signals that institutions must evolve at just the right pace in order to endure



SHRUTAPA PAUL

Did anyone else think of a Japanese samurai in a 2026 setting when they watched Naomi Osaka in all her glory? Well, I did. In her walk, in her tennis stance, in every demeanour, the Japanese-Haitian tennis player was nothing short of an elite warrior who dismantled centuries-old rigid traditions, forcing it instead to accommodate her.

I shy away from using words such as "quietly" and "shifted" — both well-known AI (artificial intelligence) tropes — but I make an exception here because that's exactly what happened. Naomi quietly, in her now well-known quirky way, shifted our perceptions of tradition, deliciously weaving in her style, culture, and heritage. If there was shock, it didn't matter. If there was awe, it felt warranted.

Within a week, the 149-year-old Wimbledon game was improved by this marriage of worlds. While it held onto its preferred practice of all-whites, Naomi balanced the strictness of the Wimbledon attire policy with her floor-touching dramatic kimono, pairing a conventional 'obi' sash with a contemporary Nike bomber jacket, and three matches in her free-robe style jacket. The embroidered sakura (cherry blossoms) were magnificent but what was equally powerful was also the message of sustainability with her outfit made using upcycled vintage kimonos and shiromuku (bridal dress). Naomi is known for her fashion statements and love of couture but this was much bigger than just fashion. Naomi exemplified what all of us today grapple with — there is space for all to exist and tradition can be tempered with modernity and open thought.

Younger generations feel ill-equipped in a world that's constantly upended by wars, viruses, and technology. The older generation feels at sea with today's tech tools. Those of us who are in-between and have straddled both the non-tech and the high-tech eras, feel outmoded and surreal every day. Today's path-breaking innovation can be a passing fad within a year. The world is moving at breakneck speed, and the notion or fear of being left behind is the latest existential crisis. The reality is that moving forward is necessary and change is the only constant. There-

fore, while we certainly have no control over the pace of things moving, there is comfort in knowing that some things will always still remain the same — in some way or the other. It's that childhood chocolate cake from your hometown confectioner or a reliable appliance from a legacy brand or a much-needed resolution from a government body. The updated versions exist along with the familiar.

It's a kind of acceptance and not resignation to new-age trends that makes the final product even more sublime. You can see it effectively used in architecture and modern design where age-old materials and cooling techniques have been successfully incorporated into urban structures. We see that in food and cooking techniques where there is a movement to preserve tastes and recipes while creating their molecular renditions. Medicine, recovery, and wellness have assimilated science with ancient wisdom. Textiles, music, art, and handicraft have all been finding their roots and serve it with a current twist. Therefore, for institutions to endure; even they must evolve. And even though they must keep pace with passing time, the trust must sustain. While I laud Naomi's aplomb, Wimbledon as the stage for her act also made space, and in a way became more inclusive. It showed that heritage can withstand in this fast-changing world, and perhaps the only way to outlive disruptions is through amalgamation; not a metamorphosis but a union.

Institutions have been built over decades, some even through centuries. They have tolerated regimes, despots, and strife, and still stand tall. Some institutions must prevail over the machinations of time as they offer crucial grounding in this age of uncertainty. Religion, banking, government, judiciary, medicine, and education have incorporated technology for survival and efficiency. They must also retain people's confidence and credence, and yield to make room for ideas and cultures. Courts, international peace bodies, humanitarian organisations, health and aid groups, central banks, human rights agencies, sport confederations, climate action coalitions — all these must stay relevant and unprejudiced, in order to continue carrying the faith that we repose in them. And to do so, they must remain open — open to imbibing technology, open to suggestions that emanate from the newer generations, open to changing just the right amount. Only then can these institutions prevent their imminent crumbling because the more things around us change, the more we will crave, and maybe even need, for some fixtures of the older world to remain.

Views expressed are personal



The symbolism extended beyond clothing to the broader question of how institutions remain relevant in rapidly changing times

DEMOGRAPHIC SHIFT

The Quality Population Imperative

With fertility below replacement level, India's next development challenge is no longer controlling population growth but investing in education, health, gender equality and human capability



AMAL CHANDRA & DEEKSHA TYAGI

For decades, India's demographic debate revolved around one question: how fast the population was growing. Public policy concentrated on fertility rates and family planning. However, the sixth National Family Health Survey (NFHS-6, 2023-24) marks a decisive transition. India has entered a new demographic era where the central challenge is no longer population size but population quality—how well people are educated, healthy, economically secure, and able to exercise agency.

As Amartya Sen's capability approach argues, economic growth and demographic advantage are meaningful only when they enhance human capabilities. In this lens, NFHS-6 is an audit of India's human capital, because its human capital drives long-term economic competitiveness.

The survey records significant progress: spousal physical or sexual violence has fallen from 29.2% to 22.3%, child marriage among women aged 20-24 declined to 20.1%, and reported sexual violence before age 18 dropped from 1.2% to 0.7%. Fertility remains below replacement level nationally, confirming the demographic transition is largely complete. Yet, these national gains mask regional disparities, as India has several vastly different social realities where human capability increasingly depends on where one is born.

No state illustrates this better than Bihar. Female secondary schooling is just 33.1%, child marriage stands at 34.6%, and spousal violence reaches 36.1%. This inter-generational cycle of educational deprivation, economic vulnerability, and gender violence cannot be broken by criminal statutes alone.

At the other end lies Kerala, which complicates conventional development assumptions. It boasts India's highest female schooling rate (86.6%) and lowest child-marriage rates (2.9%), yet reported spousal violence has sharply risen from 9.8% to 17.7%. Similarly, in Andhra Pradesh,



As India begins to age and its demographic dividend steadily narrows, the urgency of investing in human capital has never been greater

urban women report higher spousal violence than rural women despite greater workforce participation. These anomalies demonstrate that while indispensable, education and employment do not guarantee safety or autonomy. Population quality requires the capability to exercise meaningful choices.

Capability is also shaped by health and nutrition. While NFHS-6 shows continued maternal and child health improvements, persistent malnutrition and anaemia undermine cognitive development, education, and future productivity. Investing in nutrition, preventive healthcare, and early childhood development must become as central to demographic policy as expanding education.

The next phase of India's demographic policy should rest on five structural pillars:

First, secondary education must be the foremost demographic investment. NFHS-6 shows girls who stay in school are far less likely to marry early or experience adolescent pregnancy. Yet, only 46.4% of women complete ten years of schooling (compared with 54.6% of men), with rural female completion below 40%. Programmes like Beti Bachao Beti Padhao must evolve into incentives for secondary school completion.

Second, policy must move beyond financial inclusion to asset ownership, which provides real bargaining power. Though nearly 89% of women have bank accounts, only 18.8% of households report women owning land or housing. We must incentivise joint or female ownership through lower stamp duties and preferential credit.

Third, digital inclusion is essential public infrastructure. With only 64.3% of women ever using the internet compared with 80.5% of men,

Digital India should prioritise affordable smartphones, digital literacy, and rural connectivity.

Fourth, the unequal burden of reproductive responsibility must be addressed. Female sterilisation accounts for 36.5% of contraceptive use, while male sterilisation remains just 0.5%. With teenage pregnancy at 6.7%, family planning must promote male participation to support women's economic independence.

Finally, India must prepare for an ageing society. With rising life expectancy, the country faces growing demands for elderly healthcare, pensions, and age-friendly employment. Demographic success must be measured by how effectively India supports healthy, productive ageing.

As the demographic dividend narrows, investing in human capital is urgent. Future growth will depend on the productivity, health, and skills of the people India already has. The defining question is whether its people are equipped to innovate, sustain growth, and support an ageing society through evidence-based, state-specific interventions.

India's rank of 131 out of 148 in the World Economic Forum Global Gender Gap Report underscores that economic ambition cannot outpace social transformation. Equal access to education, productive assets, digital opportunities, and reproductive agency is as critical as legal reform.

India has spent decades counting its people; its next chapter must focus on investing in them. The demographic transition is complete, but the capability transition has just begun. India's future prosperity will ultimately depend on how many of its people are empowered to realise their full potential.

Views expressed are personal

DIPLOMATIC EFFORTS BETWEEN US-IRAN CONTINUE DESPITE HOSTILITIES

‘Israeli intelligence warns US of Iranian plot to assassinate Trump’

WASHINGTON: Israel has shared fresh intelligence with the United States alleging that Iran recently developed a new plan to assassinate US President Donald Trump, according to multiple media reports.

The Wall Street Journal reported that Israel passed the intelligence to US officials this week. Concurrently, CNN, citing two sources familiar with the matter, reported that the warning was delivered this week and referred to a specific alleged plot.

While the exact details of the purported plan remain unclear, CNN reported that US agencies had not independently verified the intelligence or been tracking the alleged plot before Israel's warning.

According to CNN, some US officials believe the Israeli intelligence may also be part of a broader effort by Israel to influence Trump's decision on whether to intensify American military action against Iran.

One source told the broadcaster that US intelligence has been monitoring a steady flow



US President Donald Trump

of threats against Trump in recent weeks, but described the Israeli warning as new because it referred to a specific alleged plan.

The White House declined to comment directly on the

reported intelligence, referring both The Wall Street Journal and CNN to remarks Trump made on Wednesday while speaking to reporters in Ankara, Turkey.

“They want to take out the

US leader, me,” Trump said during the press briefing.

“I’m on every list. I saw this morning, I’m on every single one of their lists. And so far, I guess I’ve been a little bit lucky, but that maybe doesn’t last very

Highlights

» The Wall Street Journal reported that Israel passed the intelligence to US officials this week

» CNN, citing two sources familiar with the matter, reported that the warning was delivered this week and referred to a specific alleged plot

» Trump said that he had recently learned of a new list ranking him as Iran's top assassination target

long.” Later, Trump also said he had recently learned of a new list ranking him as Iran's top assassination target. However, it remains unclear whether the US President was referring to the specific Israeli intelligence cited in the reports.

The latest development comes as diplomatic efforts between Washington and Tehran continue despite renewed hostilities.

AGENCIES

Unclaimed airstrikes target Iran after US attacks

DUBAI: A series of unclaimed airstrikes that hit Iran after the US said it finished its attacks have again raised questions of who else may be targeting the Islamic Republic.

The strikes Thursday, just as Iran prepared to bury the late Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, hit areas across southern Iran. The country's theocracy hasn't directly blamed anyone for the strikes, though one lawmaker issued a warning to the United Arab Emirates over allegedly providing support to the United States in its campaign against Iran.

Gulf Arab states, which repeatedly have been targeted by Iran since the war began February 28, did not immediately respond to requests for comment Friday over the strikes.

The attacks come as they and the US insist the Strait of Hormuz, a vital waterway for world energy markets, must be open and free to ships.

Iran says the strait must now be under its sole control and that vessels should begin to pay fees to Tehran — even though the world for decades has considered it an international waterway. About a fifth of all oil and natural gas trans-



The attacks raises questions of who launched them

“THE ATTACKS COME AS THEY AND THE US INSIST THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ MUST BE OPEN AND FREE TO SHIPS”

sited the strait before the war began.

Iran's grip on the strait during the conflict led to a global energy crisis, though oil prices have sharply dropped since wartime highs of USD 120 a barrel.

Israel, which took part in the Iran war, also has not claimed any recent attacks on

Iran. The US military's Central Command said Thursday around 6:30 am local Iran time that it had concluded a round of strikes that saw some 90 targets hit. Shortly after that, Iranian news outlets and state media reported a series of airstrikes and explosions targeting the country's Bushehr and Sistan and Baluchestan provinces, the cities of Ahvaz and Chabahar and other areas.

A US defence official, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss operational details of the American military campaign, said there had been no new US strikes since the last round ended Thursday morning.

AGENCIES

Trump ousts election commission members ahead of midterms in US

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump has ousted members of a bipartisan federal election commission that resisted his efforts to require would-be voters to document their US citizenship before registering.

The White House on Friday confirmed the

executive action against members of the Election Assistance Commission, which distributes federal grants to states, oversees the testing of voting systems and maintains the national voter registration forms. It's the latest move in the Republican president's effort to expand

White House influence over how US elections are conducted and comes after a recent US Supreme Court ruling that gave the president new personnel authority to fire members of independent agency boards.

“The President, and head of the Executive Branch,

reserves the right to remove individuals that may not be totally aligned with the important task of securing America's elections and ensuring every legal vote is counted.

The Slaughter decision gives the President precedence to do so,” said a White House statement to AP.

AGENCIES

Erdogan gives NATO leaders revolver conundrum after summit

ANKARA: Western leaders came to Türkiye to discuss security in an increasingly perilous world. They each left with a revolver and six rounds.

The unconventional gift from the host of this week's NATO summit, Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan, was meant to showcase his country's growing defence industry.

But it left officials across the alliance scratching their heads. Some were forced to leave their gifts behind due to gun laws in their countries, while others donated theirs to museums.

“It struck me that my gift of maple syrup kind of under-



President Recep Tayyip Erdogan, was meant to showcase Türkiye's growing defence industry

matched,” Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney told reporters, adding that the firearm was now in police

possession. “I would like to reassure Canadians, they keep guns away from me.”

AGENCIES

SL Oppn moves no trust motion against Justice minister

COLOMBO: The entire opposition on Friday signed a motion of no confidence against Sri Lanka's Minister of Justice Harshana Nanayakkara claiming that the government had failed to protect both inmates and prison officials during the Negombo prison clashes.

The violence at the Negombo prison on July 5 and 6 had killed 28 people, including eight prison officials.

AGENCIES

BSES

BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE Date: 11.07.2026

Tender under two parts (Un-priced & priced) are invited for the supply of following materials from all bidders:-

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/FK/PR/RJ/1371	RATE CONTRACT FOR THE PROCUREMENT OF VARIOUS RATINGS OF OIL TYPE DISTRIBUTION TRANSFORMERS UPTO 100 KVA IN BRPL	8.70 Crores	8,70,000	01.08.2026 15:00 HRS	01.08.2026 15:30 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹ 1180/-

For any query call on 011-49107235 or e-mail on Brpl.Eauction@reliancegroupindia.com

For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submitment of tender documents etc. please visit our website www.bsesdelhi.com

Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd. Off.: BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No: U40109DL2001PLC111527

Telephone No.: +91 11 4910 7235 | Website: www.bsesdelhi.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the general public that disputes have arisen amongst the legal heirs of Late Shri Prem Lal Grover, S/o Late Shri Devi Dayal Grover, in respect of the estate and assets left behind by the deceased, including the property bearing House No. 1420, Sector-16, Faridabad. The rights of the legal heirs in the said estate are disputed and are subject to determination in accordance with law. Accordingly, any person proposing to purchase, acquire, accept transfer of, create any charge over, or otherwise deal with the aforesaid property or any asset claimed to form part of the estate of the deceased is advised to exercise due caution and to verify the legal status and title independently before entering into any transaction. Any transaction entered into without due verification shall be at the sole risk, cost, and consequences of the concerned person. This notice is issued without prejudice to the legal rights and remedies available to the undersigned, all of which are expressly reserved.

Rajiv Grover

Legal Heir of Late Shri Prem Lal Grover

R/o House No. 1420, Sector-16, Faridabad

Date: 02.07.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

1. Sh. Rajiv Grover, aged about 45 years, Son of Late Shri Prem Lal Grover R/o House No. 1420, Sector-16, Faridabad, do hereby issue this Public Notice for the information of the general public: That owing to personal reasons and irreconcilable differences, I have decided to sever all personal, social and financial relations with my elder brother namely Sh. Sanjay Grover, Son of Late Shri Prem Lal Grover, with immediate effect. I hereby declare that the said Sh. Sanjay Grover has neither been authorized nor is he authorized to represent me in any capacity or to act as my agent, attorney, nominee or representative in relation to any personal, financial, commercial or legal matter whatsoever. Any representation, assurance, commitment, promise, agreement, transaction or other act purportedly made by him in my name or on my behalf shall not be binding upon me, and I expressly disclaim any liability or responsibility arising therefrom. I further declare that I shall not be responsible for any loan, debt, financial liability, contractual obligation, business dealing, guarantee or any other act or omission of Sh. Sanjay Grover undertaken by him in his individual capacity. The general public, banks, financial institutions, government authorities, business entities and all other concerned persons are hereby cautioned not to enter into any transaction or dealing with Sh. Sanjay Grover on the assumption that he is acting for, representing or has any authority from me. Any person dealing with him on such assumption shall do so entirely at his or her own risk, responsibility and consequences. This public notice is being issued solely to avoid any misunderstanding or unauthorized use of my name and to safeguard my legal rights and interests. Nothing contained herein shall be construed as affecting or curtailing any legal rights, or obligations arising under any applicable law.

Rajiv Grover

Legal Heir of Late Shri Prem Lal Grover

R/o House No. 1420, Sector-16, Faridabad

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(SUCCESSION CASE).

IN THE COURT OF Sh. Rajeev
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Hisar

Rajiv Jain s/o Late Rattan Sagar Jain R/o
H.no. 231/5, Gandhi Chowk, Hisar, Tehsil
& Distt Hisar

Vs.

1. GENERAL PUBLIC

2. Deepak Jain s/o Late Rattan Sagar Jain
R/o H.no. 16618 Jyoti Pura Mohalla, Hisar

3. Jyoti Jain w/o Rajeev Jain and D/o Late
Rattan Sagar Jain R/o 1/10925, Street No.
7, West Subas Park, Naveen Shahdara,
District East Delhi, Delhi-110032

Petition U/s 372 of the Indian Succession
Act, 1925 for the grant of Succession
Certificate.

CNR No. HRHS02-001535-2026

Next Date 25-08-2026

NOTICE TO:
GENERAL PUBLIC

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/
respondent(s) could not be served. It is
ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s)
shall appear in person or through
counsel on 25-08-2026 at 10:00 a.m.

For details login to <https://highcourtcdh.gov.in/?mod=district>

Notice&district=Hisar

Sd/-Sh. Rajeev
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
date 10.07.2026

Hisar

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, धनबाद

इशतिहार का प्रकाशन

सरकार बनाम

शशांक सिंह, पे0-महेश सिंह, पता- 38 वैशाली नगर अपोजिट हापुर्ना इक्लेव पाल(रूरल),
थाना-बोरानाडा, जिला-जोधपुर, पिन-342001

SPL JUDGE pocso.DHANAD

गोविन्दपुर थाना कांड सं0-350 / 23, दिनांक-03.11.23, धारा 364 माददवि0 एवं 08 पोकोसो एक्ट ।
आप को इस नोटिस के माध्यम से सूचित किया जाता है कि उपरोक्त वाद में आपके विरुद्ध माननीय न्यायालय से इशतिहार जारी
किया गया है।
अतः आपको इस प्रकाशन के जरिए आग्रह किया जाता है कि माननीय न्यायालय में उपस्थित होकर अपना पक्ष रखें।
इसे ताक़िद समझें।

0326-2220802 (वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक कार्यालय, धनबाद)
94711-91054 (पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, मु0-01, धनबाद)
094317-06399 (थाना प्रभारी, गोविन्दपुर, धनबाद)

**वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
धनबाद।**

PR 384686 (Police) 26-27 (D)

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

EXTENSION OF PERIODICITY OF SUMMER SPECIAL TRAINS

This is notified for the information of rail passengers that Railways have decided to extend the periodicity of the run of following Summer Special Trains as under:-

Train No.	From	To	Frequency	Earlier Notified Up-to	Extended Up-to	Trips
02563	Barauni Jn.	New Delhi	Daily	15.07.2026	31.07.2026	16
02564	New Delhi	Barauni Jn.	Daily	16.07.2026	01.08.2026	16
02569	Darbhangha	New Delhi	Daily	15.07.2026	31.07.2026	16
02570	New Delhi	Darbhangha	Daily	16.07.2026	01.08.2026	16
03257	Danapur	Anand Vihar (T.)	Sunday	12.07.2026	26.07.2026	02
03258	Anand Vihar (T.)	Danapur	Monday	13.07.2026	27.07.2026	02
05219	Muzaffarpur	Anand Vihar (T.)	Friday	10.07.2026	31.07.2026	03
05220	Anand Vihar (T.)	Muzaffarpur	Saturday	11.07.2026	01.08.2026	03
03639	Dhanbad	Shakur Basti	Mon, Fri	13.07.2026	31.07.2026	05
03640	Shakur Basti	Dhanbad	Tue, Sat	14.07.2026	01.08.2026	05
02397	Sheikhpura	Anand Vihar (T.)	Sunday	12.07.2026	26.07.2026	02
02398	Anand Vihar (T.)	Sheikhpura	Monday	13.07.2026	27.07.2026	02
03697	Sheikhpura	Anand Vihar (T.)	Mo, Tu, Fr, Sa	14.07.2026	31.07.2026	09
03698	Anand Vihar (T.)	Sheikhpura	Tu, We, Sa, Su	15.07.2026	01.08.2026	09
05579	Purnia Court	Anand Vihar (T.)	Fri, Sun	12.07.2026	31.07.2026	03
05580	Anand Vihar (T.)	Purnia Court	Sun, Tue	14.07.2026	02.08.2026	03
05575	Saharsa	Anand Vihar (T.)	Tuesday	14.07.2026	28.07.2026	01
05576	Anand Vihar (T.)	Saharsa	Thursday	16.07.2026	30.07.2026	01
04811	Barmer	Haridwar	Mon, Thu	16.07.2026	27.08.2026	12
04812	Haridwar	Barmer	Tue, Fri	17.07.2026	28.08.2026	12

Note : Rest other instructions will hold good.

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

2366/26

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

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SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रॉंची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना

अज्ञात पुरुष का शव

उपरोक्त अज्ञात पुरुष का शव तमाड़ थाना क्षेत्र अन्तर्गत प्रतापपुर जाने वाली पक्की सड़क स्थित पुलिसिया के नीचे के केनल के पास से बरामद किया गया है। शव की पहचान अबतक नहीं हो सकी है। जिसके संबंध में तमाड़ थाना काण्ड सं0-40 / 2026, दिनांक-01.07.2026, धारा-103(1) बी0एन0एस0 दर्ज किया गया है। इनकी पहचान हेतु जनता का सहयोग अपेक्षित है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि आपको इस पुरुष के शव के बारे में जानकारी हो तो वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय रॉंची में या संबंधित थाना या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

अनु0 पु0 पदा0 बुण्ड, रॉंची।

अनु0 पु0 पदा0 बुण्ड, रॉंची।

—943170614

—9431706193

**वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
रॉंची**

PR 384647 (Police)26-27*D

AROUND 23 MISSING Spain wildfires kill at least 12 people

MADRID: One of Spain's deadliest wildfires on record killed 12 people overnight into Friday, authorities said, as soaring temperatures grip much of the country.

Several victims of the fire in the southern province of Almeria, a popular holiday destination, were found inside burnt-out vehicles and were thought to have died while trying to flee the flames.

Eight people have been injured and a further 23 are unaccounted for, Andalusia's regional leader Juan Manuel Moreno said. Some 150 fire-fighters and 220 soldiers from Spain's military emergency unit were battling the blaze, which

has consumed more than 3,200 hectares of forest and farmland. Regional emergency authorities said four British nationals and other unspecified foreign nationals appeared to be among the dead. The fire broke out in a hamlet in a semi-arid area near the Sierra de Los Filabres mountains. Authorities have not confirmed the cause, but said people who called to report the fire said that a fallen power line had sparked a blaze that spread rapidly into a nearby forest.

Most of the victims died while attempting to flee and ignored shelter-in-place instructions, said Antonio Sanz, president of Andalusia's emergency services.

AGENCIES

India notifies process to claim UK FTA vehicle import tariff quotas

Under CETA, India will reduce import duties on automotive imports from about 110 per cent to 10 per cent, with quotas on both sides

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India has notified the procedure for importers to seek government approval to avail quota-based duty concessions on imports of passenger cars and goods vehicles under the free trade agreement with the UK, which will come into force on July 15.

Under the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), India will reduce import duties on automotive imports from about 110 per cent to 10 per cent, with quotas on both sides.

India is allowing import of 3.78 lakh units of conventional-engine passenger cars, including those in the mass segment, from the UK at concessional customs duty during the first 15 years of the implementation of the trade pact between the two countries.

“Procedure for allocation of Tariff Rate Quotas (TRQ) under India-UK (CETA) is notified,” the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) has said in a public notice dated July 9.

It said that at the time of clearance of the import consignment, the importer in India has to produce a Certificate of Origin issued by concerned



authorities in the UK.

“Only Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs), Dealers/Channel Partners duly authorised by the OEMs of vehicles originating in the UK shall be eligible to apply for the TRQ,” it added.

The DGFT also said that to be eligible, each applicant will have to submit a pre-purchase agreement issued by an OEM of the vehicles in the UK setting out the quantity of vehicles agreed to be supplied to the applicant during the TRQ year.

“The year in respect of these imports will be the period from 1st January to 31st December,

i.e., calendar year in India. DGFT shall monitor the cumulative quantities for TRQ Certificates issued. No TRQ Certificates shall be issued once the stated TRQ quantity limit is reached,” it said.

These certificates, it said, will be valid for a maximum period of 12 months or till the end of the calendar year, whichever is earlier.

“Importers under TRQ shall endeavour to pass on the benefits of the concessional customs duty available under the TRQ to the final buyer or consumer,” it added.

For imports from the UK

HIGHLIGHTS

» India is allowing import of 3.78 lakh units of conventional-engine cars, from the UK at concessional customs duty in first 15 years

» ‘Procedure for allocation of Tariff Rate Quotas (TRQ) under India-UK (CETA) is notified’

» In first five years, India has not given any concessions for electric/hybrid/hydrogen-cars

being reduced to 50 per cent from 66 per cent.

In the mass market segment of engine size of up to 1,500 cc, the allowed quota of import in the first year of the pact is 5,000 units, with customs duty being reduced to 50 per cent from 66 per cent, as per the document.

A total of 20,000 units of passenger cars across the three categories will be allowed to be imported in the first year under the agreement.

India has not opened its market for vehicles priced below GBP 40,000 (CIF), ensuring complete protection for the mass-market EV segment in which India seeks global leadership through its homegrown firms like Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra, besides Maruti Suzuki.

In the first five years, India has not given any concessions for electric/hybrid/hydrogen-passenger cars, but from the 6th year, such vehicles priced between GBP 40,000 CIF (Cost, Insurance, and Freight) to GBP 80,000 CIF (inclusive), the duties will be reduced to 50 per cent with a quota size of 400 units, while for those vehicles priced above GBP 80,000 CIF, the duties will be lowered to 40 per cent with an import limit of 4,000 units.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended 1 per cent higher on Friday, extending gains for the second day, aided by a rally in heavyweights Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL), ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank, and positive global cues.

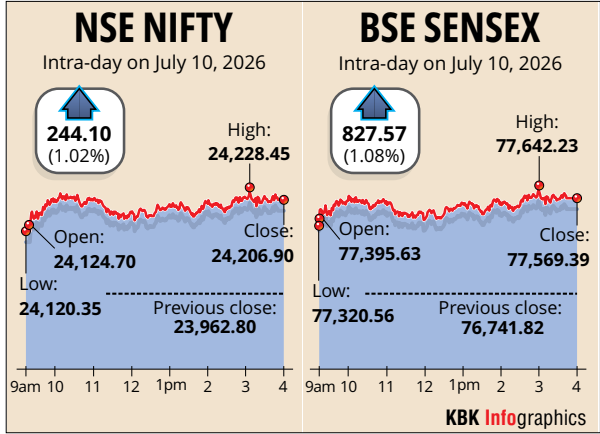
Easing crude oil prices and buying in IT stocks after TCS reported an increase in its June-quarter net profit and guided towards an improvement in demand returning in the ongoing quarter also propelled the rally in the domestic market.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 827.57 points, or 1.08 per cent, to settle at 24,206.90. During the day, it soared 900.41 points, or 1.17 per cent, to 77,642.23.

The 50-share NSE Nifty surged 244.10 points, or 1.02 per cent, to end at 24,206.90. From the Sensex pack, Reliance Industries, Tech Mahindra, Bharat Electronics, Axis Bank, Tata Steel and Infosys were among the major winners.

TCS ended 1 per cent higher after the country’s largest IT services company on Thursday reported a 4.61 per cent increase in its Q1FY27 net profit to Rs 13,349 crore, and guided towards an improvement in demand impacted by the West Asia crisis, returning in the ongoing quarter.

The laggards from the blue-



All sectors ended in positive territory. Realty surged 3.40%, PSU Bank 3.26%, MidSmall Pvt Banks Quality Tilt 2.56%, Focused IT 2.29%, IT 2.01%, Metal 1.55% and Services 1.50%

chip pack were Eternal, Bharti Airtel, Sun Pharma and Trent.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, dipped 0.30 per cent to \$76.07 per barrel.

The BSE MidCap Select index jumped 1.74 per cent and the SmallCap Select index climbed 1.03 per cent.

All sectors ended in positive territory. Realty surged 3.40 per

cent, PSU Bank 3.26 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 2.56 per cent, Focused IT 2.29 per cent, Information Technology 2.01 per cent, Metal 1.55 per cent and Services 1.50 per cent.

A total of 2,883 stocks advanced, while 1,377 declined and 174 remained unchanged on the BSE.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark declined 194.52 points, or 0.25 per cent, and the Nifty dipped 63.95 points, or 0.26 per cent.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 532.86 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the Sensex climbed 238.22 points, or 0.31 per cent, to settle at 76,741.82. The Nifty went up by 80.75 points, or 0.34 per cent, to end at 23,962.80.

India’s forex stocks rise \$7.26 bn to \$674.193 bn

MUMBAI: India’s forex reserves jumped \$7.26 billion to \$674.193 billion during the week ended July 3, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the forex kitty had dropped by \$5.654 billion to \$666.933 billion.

The kitty had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the Middle East conflict, which led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the Reserve Bank had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

For the week ended July 3, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased \$4.51 billion to \$545.578 billion, the central bank’s data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

Value of gold reserves jumped \$2.669 billion to \$105.205 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The special drawing rights (SDRs) were up \$65 million at \$18.623 billion, the apex bank said.

India’s reserve position with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) was also up by \$15 million to \$4.787 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the apex bank’s data. PFI

BoM’s net profit rises 27% to ₹2,020 cr in Q1

Total income in Q1 FY27 rose to Rs 9,063 cr from Rs 7,879 cr in Q1 FY26

NEW DELHI: Bank of Maharashtra (BoM) on Friday reported a 27 per cent jump in net profit to Rs 2,020 crore for the first quarter of the current fiscal.

The Pune-based lender had posted a net profit of Rs 1,593 crore in the year-ago period. Total income in the quarter under review rose to Rs 9,063 crore from Rs 7,879 crore in the same period a year ago, the state-owned lender said in a regulatory filing.

Interest earned by the bank grew to Rs 8,037 crore as compared to Rs 7,054 crore in the June quarter of FY26.

The bank’s asset qual-



ity showed improvement as gross non-performing assets (NPAs) declined to 1.45 per cent of gross advances at the end of the June quarter FY27 from 1.74 per cent a year ago.

Similarly, net non-performing assets or bad loans declined to 0.13 per cent as against 0.18 per cent in the year-ago period. PFI

Central & Bihar govt agree to accelerate PM Surya Ghar and PM-KUSUM Schemes

NEW DELHI: Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and Union Minister for New & Renewable Energy Pralhad Joshi on Thursday reviewed the progress of renewable energy projects in the state, with officials stating that projects worth nearly Rs 1.35 lakh crore are under implementation.

The meeting at Sankalp, 1 Anne Marg reviewed PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, PM-KUSUM, Utility-Led Aggregation (ULA), floating solar projects, Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS), the Green Energy Corridor, small hydro projects and the solarisation of government buildings.

Ajay Yadav, Energy Secretary, Bihar, and Chairman & Managing Director, Bihar



State Power Holding Company Ltd (BSPHCL), presented the status and future roadmap of renewable energy projects. Santosh Kumar Sarangi, Secretary, Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE), who attended virtually, assured continued technical, policy and financial

NEW DELHI: Markets regulator Sebi on Friday expanded the scope of intraday borrowing by mutual funds, allowing asset management companies (AMCs) to use such facilities for a wider range of cash management needs arising from settlement timing mismatches.

The revised framework, which comes into effect from September 1, follows amendments to the Sebi (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 2026, notified on July 3.

Earlier, mutual funds were permitted to borrow only to meet temporary liquidity needs caused by differences in market redemption timings, Sebi said in its circular. The regulator said intraday borrowing can be availed against receivables expected during the day, including guaranteed inflows such as



(mark-to-market) obligations and foreign exchange settlements, and ‘repayment of existing borrowings’ in addition to unitholder payouts.

The move is aimed at addressing liquidity mismatches caused by differences in market settlement timings, Sebi said in its circular. The regulator said intraday borrowing can be availed against receivables expected during the day, including guaranteed inflows such as

funds from the RBI, clearing corporations and subscription proceeds received in scheme bank accounts.

It can also be backed by non-guaranteed receivables sighted during the day, including maturity proceeds and secondary market settlements from instruments such as non-convertible debentures (NCDs), commercial papers (CPs), certificates of deposit (CDs) and over-the-counter (OTC) swaps, provided these are expected to be received by the scheme before the end of the day.

In addition, AMCs may avail intraday borrowing beyond these receivables solely to meet redemption and other unitholder payout obligations permitted under Mutual Fund Regulations.

Sebi has made AMCs

responsible for ensuring that all intraday borrowings are repaid by the end of the day. Any borrowing that rolls over into an overnight borrowing must remain within the regulatory borrowing limits and be used only for purposes permitted under the regulations.

The regulator has also mandated that the boards of AMCs and trustees approve a policy governing the use of intraday borrowing facilities. The policy, covering aspects such as approval processes and monitoring mechanisms, must be disclosed on the AMC’s website.

Further, AMCs have been directed to maintain scheme-wise records explaining the underlying liquidity mismatch and the expected source of repayment for every intraday borrowing. PFI

Rlnfra subsidiary MMOPL cuts debt by ₹1,100 crore, comes out of insolvency

NEW DELHI: Reliance Infrastructure (Rlnfra) on Friday said its subsidiary Mumbai Metro One Private Ltd (MMOPL) has reduced debt by more than Rs 1,100 crore as on March 31, 2026, which will lead to the withdrawal of insolvency proceedings against the company. MMOPL entered into a debt restructuring agreement with National Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd (NARCL) on July 9, Rlnfra said in a regulatory filing. The agreement is valued at Rs 2,771.32 crore.

MMOPL is a joint venture between Rlnfra & MMRDA, which owns, operates and maintains the Versova-Andheri-Ghatkopar Metro Line-1, while reinforcing its long-term operational sustainability. PFI

while the remaining 26 per cent is held by Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority. According to the filing, the restructuring will result in a reduction in MMOPL’s current debt payable to NARCL by over Rs 1,100 crore & the withdrawal of the insolvency proceedings initiated against MMOPL.

Rlnfra said the debt restructuring marks a significant milestone in resolving MMOPL’s debt and strengthening its financial position, enabling it to continue focusing on the efficient and uninterrupted operation and maintenance of the Versova-Andheri-Ghatkopar Metro Line-1, while reinforcing its long-term operational sustainability. PFI

Indian Bank reports 10% rise in net profit to ₹3,273 cr in Q1 FY27

NEW DELHI: State-owned Indian Bank on Friday posted a 10 per cent rise in net profit to Rs 3,273 crore in the first quarter of the current financial year.

The Chennai-based lender had earned a net profit of Rs 2,973 crore in the same quarter of the previous fiscal.

The lender’s total income increased to Rs 20,724 crore during the June quarter of 2026-27 from Rs 18,721 crore in the same period of FY26, Indian Bank said in a regulatory filing.

Interest earned by the bank also improved to Rs 18,090

crore, compared to Rs 16,283 crore in the year-ago period.

Net Interest Income (NII) increased by 17 per cent to Rs 7,435 crore from Rs 6,359 crore in the June quarter of FY26, it said. During the period under review, its operating profit increased to Rs 5,557 crore from Rs 4,770 crore in the same quarter a year ago.

The bank’s asset quality showed improvement as gross NPAs declined to 1.86 per cent of gross advances at the end of the June quarter from 3.01 per cent a year ago. Similarly, net

NPAs, or bad loans, declined to 0.15 per cent, against 0.18 per cent in the year-ago period.

As a result, provisions for bad loans declined to Rs 376 crore during the first quarter from Rs 387 crore a year ago.

Provision Coverage Ratio (PCR) remained static at 98.2 per cent during the quarter.

At the same time, Return on Assets (ROA) improved to 1.34 per cent for June 2026 against 1.03 per cent in June 2025. Capital adequacy ratio of the bank declined to 17.80 per cent from 17.99 per cent in Q1 FY26. PFI

NEW DELHI/RANCHI:

Jharkhand showcased its tourism and investment potential during the second day of the National Stakeholders’ Consultation 2026 at Hotel Taj Palace in New Delhi, where policymakers, industry leaders and tourism experts discussed strategies to position the state as a leading tourism destination.

The session, titled “Destination Jharkhand: Driving Tourism Investment and Inclusive Development,” highlighted that the state recorded 5.85 crore tourist visits in 2024, including 4.4 crore pilgrim visits, under-

CLOSER LOOK

» The government said granting industry status to tourism has opened avenues for private investment, institutional finance and infrastructure development

» Jharkhand is promoting religious, eco, wildlife, adventure, mining and tribal tourism, backed by the proposed Tourism Policy 2026, Homestay Policy 2026

» ‘Jharkhand aims to be known not only for its mineral wealth but also for its natural beauty’

scoring its growing appeal.

The government said granting industry status to tourism has opened avenues for private investment, institutional

finance and infrastructure development.

Jharkhand is promoting religious, eco, wildlife, adventure, mining and tribal tour-

ism, backed by the proposed Tourism Policy 2026, Homestay Policy 2026, digital single-window registration and investor-friendly reforms. Investment opportunities have been identified in hotels, resorts, ropeways, skywalks, water sports, floating restaurants, houseboats, camping sites and experiential tourism projects.

Tourism, Art, Culture, Sports and Youth Affairs Minister Sudhivya Kumar said Jharkhand aims to be known not only for its mineral wealth but also for its natural beauty. He said the proposed Home-

stay Policy would generate large-scale rural employment and help establish the state as a leading homestay destination.

The minister said the government, under the leadership of the Chief Minister, was promoting Jharkhand’s cultural, spiritual and natural heritage nationwide and assured investors of a conducive business environment. The event was attended by Ministers Deepika Pandey Singh, Sanjay Prasad, Irfan Ansari, and Shilpi Neha Turkey, Minister for Agriculture, Animal Husbandry and Cooperation. MPOST

NATIONAL STAKEHOLDERS’ CONSULTATION 2026

Jharkhand showcases tourism investment potential

INVITES INDIAN COMPANIES TO INVEST

Afghanistan seeks India’s co-op to modernise agricultural practices

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Afghanistan Minister Mawlawi Attaullah Omari on Friday sought India’s cooperation to modernise its farming, livestock and irrigation practices with advanced technologies, highlighting the long-standing ties between the two nations.

He called for greater collaboration in agricultural mechanisation, certified seeds, food processing, cold-chain infrastructure, packaging, livestock development, irrigation, renewable energy, and rural development, while inviting Indian companies to invest in organic fertilizer production, agri-processing, and technology transfer.



Afghan Agriculture, Irrigation, and Livestock Minister Mawlawi Attaullah Omari speaks at the Industry Interactive Session on India-Afghanistan Trade Opportunities at PHD House, in New Delhi on Friday.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Omari reaffirmed his govt’s commitment to facilitate investments & strengthening long-term partnerships with India
- » Relations between India & Afghanistan are strong & we must make efforts to make them even stronger, Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor, Charge d’Affaires, Afghan Embassy said
- » He assured the Afghanistan Embassy’s full support in facilitating business partnerships

your (India’s) kind cooperation, collaboration in all aspects, to improve the life and situation of our people,” he said at a PHDCCI event. The minister reaffirmed the Afghan government’s commitment to facilitating investments and strengthening long-term partnerships with Indian industry for the prosperity of both nations.

“From the day I landed in India, I received a warm welcome from the Indian government, Minister of External Affairs, and with whoever I meet. So I feel like it is my own people, I don’t feel like I am in an unfamiliar place... I feel just like you said, our DNA is one,” Omari said.

The minister expressed his gratitude to the government

of India for the warm hospitality extended to the Afghan delegation during his first visit to India.

Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor, Charge d’Affaires, Embassy of Afghanistan, New Delhi, emphasised the centuries-old civilizational and people-to-people ties between India and Afghanistan and noted that recent diplomatic engagements

have created renewed momentum for expanding bilateral economic relations.

He emphasised that the relations between India and Afghanistan are strong, and we must make efforts to make them even stronger.

Inviting Indian businesses to explore opportunities in agriculture, water management, renewable energy, mining, infrastructure, and tourism, he stated that Afghanistan today offers a secure and investment-friendly environment with significant potential for trade and long-term investments.

He assured the Afghanistan Embassy’s full support in facilitating business partnerships and strengthening economic cooperation between the two countries.

“Our political relationship is continuously moving forward in a positive direction. On the other hand, our bilateral trade relationship is also progressing. The war between US and Iran has affected the entire world, still the traders of India and Afghanistan are working to ensure the India-Afghanistan trade retains its positive momentum,” he said.

Equity mutual fund schemes attract ₹28,973 crore in June

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Equity-oriented mutual fund schemes attracted Rs 28,973 crore in June, a sharp surge of 26.5 per cent from the preceding month, driven by easing geopolitical tensions, expectations of supportive domestic macroeconomic conditions, and strong retail participation.

With this, net inflow into equity schemes reached to Rs 1.81 lakh crore in the first half of 2026, up 12 per cent from the Rs 1.61 lakh crore garnered in the same period of 2025.

Moreover, monthly SIP contributions rose to Rs 31,781 crore during the month under review, up from Rs 30,954 crore in May, according to data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (Amfi) on Friday.

Overall, the mutual fund industry’s net outflow narrowed to Rs 52,949 crore in June from an outflow of Rs 64,131 crore in the preceding month. Consequently, the industry’s asset base rose to Rs 82.22 lakh crore at the end of June from Rs 81.6 lakh crore a month earlier.

According to the data, net inflows into equity schemes stood at Rs 28,973 crore in June, compared with Rs 22,908 crore in May, which was the lowest level in a year. The rebound indicates that investor confi-

Monthly SIP contributions rose to Rs 31,781 crore during the month under review, up from Rs 30,954 crore in May, according to data released by Amfi

dence remains resilient despite ongoing global uncertainties and periodic market volatility.

“Improved market sentiment, expectations of supportive domestic macroeconomic conditions, and continued strength in retail participation helped support flows during the month,” Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst, Morningstar Investment Research India, said.

Inflows in equities stood at Rs 38,440 crore in April, Rs 40,450 crore in March, Rs 25,978 crore in February and Rs 24,028 crore in January.

Within the equity category, mid-cap funds attracted the highest inflows at Rs 6,090 crore, followed by small-cap funds at Rs 5,602 crore and flexi cap funds at Rs 5,231 crore. Large cap funds received an inflow of Rs 2,067 crore.

On the other hand, dividend

yield funds and equity-linked savings schemes (ELSS) saw net outflows during the month.

Also, gold exchange traded funds (ETFs) recorded a net inflow of Rs 3,443 crore in June against a net outflow of Rs 725 crore in May.

The sharp recovery suggests that the weakness witnessed in May was temporary and largely driven by tactical profit-taking. Moreover, it indicates renewed buying as investors capitalised on recent price corrections, Meshram said.

On a cumulative basis, gold ETFs attracted net inflows of Rs 37,319 crore during H1 CY2026, significantly higher than the Rs 8,021 crore recorded during H1 CY2025.

Debt-oriented schemes recorded a net outflow of Rs 1.09 lakh crore in June, following a withdrawal of Rs 96,948 crore in May. This was primarily due to heavy redemptions in ultra-short-term categories to meet predictable, seasonal quarter-end institutional liquidity requirements, said Umesh Sharma, CIO-Debt, The Wealth Company Mutual Fund.

Liquid fund redemptions worsened to Rs 42,293 crore from Rs 29,681 crore in May, while overnight fund outflows compressed to Rs 10,580 crore down from Rs 15,524 crore in May.

Adani, France’s Dioxyce partner to develop low-carbon chemicals

NEW DELHI: Adani Enterprises Ltd has partnered with French clean-technology firm Dioxyce to develop low-carbon chemical manufacturing in India, starting with a pilot plant to produce formic acid using captured carbon dioxide and renewable electricity.

The pilot facility will be set up at an Adani Group site and will demonstrate the conversion of captured carbon emissions into industrial chemicals using renewable power. The partners

plan to scale up the technology for commercial production after successful validation of the pilot.

The collaboration marks Adani Group’s entry into the low-carbon chemicals segment, complementing its existing businesses in renewable energy and infrastructure. The companies will also explore manufacturing other industrial chemicals used in energy, materials, packaging and manufacturing sectors, many

of which currently depend on fossil fuel-based feedstocks.

“We are proud to pilot India’s first formic acid production facility powered entirely by renewable electricity and captured carbon. This partnership with Dioxyce is a testament to how strategic industrial synergies can turn carbon liabilities into sustainable, cost-effective economic assets,” said Jeet Adani, Director, Adani Group.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Exide Industries has set a Rs 20,000 crore revenue target for its core lead-acid battery business to be achieved by FY 28. Also, despite the geopolitical uncertainties, particularly in West Asia, which kept commodity and energy prices volatile, Avik Roy, MD and CEO of Exide Industries Ltd, said the company had achieved standalone revenue of Rs 17,269 crore, registering year-on-year growth of 4.1 per cent in FY26.

“As I look back on FY 2025-26, I would describe it as a year that tested our resilience and



Avik Roy, MD and CEO of Exide Industries Ltd

adaptability. We operated in an environment marked by geopolitical uncertainty, fluctuations in commodity prices and currencies, evolving battery technologies and uneven demand across sectors. Despite these

headwinds, the company delivered a stable and resilient performance,” said Roy at the 79th Annual General Meeting.

Exide Industries also expects its Bengaluru lithium-ion cell manufacturing plant to begin generating revenue from the third quarter of the current fiscal, with supplies of domestically manufactured battery cells to EVs and energy storage systems set to commence. The company has already invested around Rs 4,800 crore in the Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) manufacturing facility and plans to invest an additional Rs 1,400 crore during the

current fiscal to complete the first phase of the project, Roy said. Industry estimates project domestic demand for lithium-ion cells to rise to around 130 GWh by 2030, of which nearly 100 GWh is expected to come from electric vehicles, he said.

Roy mentioned that the Automotive OEM business recorded strong double-digit growth during the year, with demand momentum accelerating significantly in the second half following the rollout of GST 2.0. “We were the partner of choice for OEMs, as evidenced by our 100% share of business across multiple new

vehicle launches,” he said.

He added that the Home UPS and Battery business delivered high single-digit growth during the year. “While demand was impacted in the early part of the year by an extended monsoon and temporary GST-related purchase deferrals, momentum improved significantly in the second half,” he said.

Looking ahead to FY 2026-27, the company sees encouraging opportunities across automotive OEM, automotive replacement, industrial UPS, railways, solar, data centres and infrastructure.

Sport

I’MBAPPE

Mbappé overcomes penalty miss to inspire France to 3rd straight semis

FOXBOROUGH: Kylian Mbappé spread his arms out wide and spun around after scoring his eighth goal of this year’s World Cup. He later gave the jubilant France fans dotted around the stadium a wave when he left the game because of an injury scare.

Les Bleus, with a star striker who said he’s fine despite a right ankle issue, are headed back to the semi-finals for the third straight World Cup tournament.

Mbappé had a goal and an assist after missing a first-half penalty kick, Ousmane Dembélé also scored and two-time champion France beat Morocco 2-0 on Thursday in the quarterfinals.

“There’s only one way to relax, and that’s by winning. Until we’ve done that, we don’t let up,” Mbappé said. “We’re in the semi-finals and we’re very happy, but there’s still a long way to go.”

Mbappé’s goal in the 60th minute was the 20th of his World Cup career and came in his 20th match at the tournament, moving him one behind Argentina captain Lionel Messi. Dembélé scored his fifth goal of the tournament in the 66th.

Mbappé went down to the ground in the 76th minute, about 13 minutes after



France's Kylian Mbappe celebrates scoring the opening goal against Morocco

being hit hard by a Moroccan defender, and was taken off for a substitute a minute later. He was then shown sitting on the bench with an ice pack on his right ankle.

After the match and with both shoes on, Mbappé ran and jumped in celebration with his teammates.

“I took a knock to the ankle, but I’m fine,” Mbappé said. “At that point, JP (Jean-Philippe Mateta) was in better shape than I was to play the final minutes.”

France beat Morocco by

the same score in the semi-finals of the 2022 tournament

in Qatar when the Atlas Lions became the first African team to make it that far. France now remains on track to become only the third nation to play in the final of three consecutive World Cups.

“It is a confirmation of how we’ve played so far,” said France coach Didier Deschamps, who added there is a reason for his team’s success in recent World Cups.

“Having great players. Excellent players. My credit goes to the players. But maybe I do my job well,” he said. AGENCIES

Egypt get warm home welcome

EL-ALAMEIN: Thousands of fans turned out to greet Egypt’s national team on its return home Friday after its World Cup adventure ended with a 3-2 loss to Argentina in the knockout stage of the tournament. Crowds gathered at the el-Alamein airport, waving photos of star player Mohamed Salah and holding signs celebrating the team’s achievements as they cheered the players’ return.

Egypt made it to the last 16 teams in the tournament for the first time after beating Australia 4-2 on penalty kicks, led by Salah.

The players are expected to meet Saturday with Egyptian President Abdel-Fattah el-Sissi, who thanked the team in a Facebook statement on Tuesday “for their honorable performance and for achieving an unprecedented milestone in the history of Egyptian soccer.” AGENCIES

LOAD PRESSURE ON ENGLAND

Haaland & Norway row with the flow ahead of Eng clash

MIAMI: The six decades since England’s lone World Cup triumph will come into sharper focus as they head towards Saturday’s quarter-final against a Norway team with one of the best strikers in the game but happy to embrace the underdog role.

Erling Haaland has been one of the stars of the tournament with his seven goals taking Norway into uncharted territory at their first World Cup for 28 years -- his double against Brazil in the last 16 already the stuff of internet memes.

England will think they have more overall quality and are far more familiar with this stage of major tournaments, having reached the quarter-finals or better at three World Cups and two European Championships in the last eight years.

The 1966 World Cup triumph on home soil remains their only major international title, however, and expectations back home reach fever pitch every time they make the business end of a tournament.

Norway have clearly decided that this could work to their advantage with midfielder Kristian Thorstvedt on Thursday saying his team “don’t have much to lose” and Haaland looking to enlist the media



Erling Haaland has scored seven goals, including two against Brazil

Norway’s World Cup qualification has transformed Haaland into the team’s face

to help ramp up the pressure on England.

“I think there are some clear favourites out there, England is one of them, so I think all of you should put every single pressure on the English lads,” the 25-year-old English-born striker told reporters with a grin. The charismatic Haaland is very much a known quantity to Saturday’s opposition after four years in the Premier League and has five current and

former clubmates in the England squad. “We’ll treat them with the same respect we show every opponent,” said one of them, defender John Stones.

Norway’s run to the last eight has been about more than Haaland and playmaker Martin Odegaard, however, with a tight bond in the squad manifesting itself in their performances.

“There’s very little negative energy in the group,” midfielder Morten Thorsby said. “We’ve been together a long time, and we have a very good time together.” England showed that they too have developed a strong team spirit when, despite being reduced to 10 men, they beat co-hosts Mexico in the last 16 with a backs-against-the-wall win. AGENCIES

TEN DOESCHATE’S WAKE-UP CALL AFTER ENGLAND DRUBBING

‘Time to accept India’s overseas reality’

BRISTOL: India assistant coach Ryan ten Doeschate feels the immediate challenge facing the current T20 world champions is to shed the “underachievers” tag in foreign conditions and need to understand the process of adapting quickly to varied playing environments.

After being clean swept by Ireland in the two T20Is, India, under Shreyas Iyer’s captaincy,

cut a sorry figure in England as the hosts thrashed the visitors by nine wickets in the fourth T20 to take a 3-0 lead in the five-match series on Thursday. “We have spoken so much about adaptability, it’s easy to say we need to adapt, but really it’s a point now where we need to understand the process, what is needed to make those adaptations,” he said. AGENCIES

cut a sorry figure in England as the hosts thrashed the visitors by nine wickets in the fourth T20 to take a 3-0 lead in the five-match series on Thursday. “We have spoken so much about adaptability, it’s easy to say we need to adapt, but really it’s a point now where we need to understand the process, what is needed to make those adaptations,” he said. AGENCIES

Zverev writes final chapter of the ‘Ferytale’

LONDON: Alexander Zverev will play for another major trophy, this time in the Wimbledon final, a month after winning his first Grand Slam title at the French Open.

Zverev ended the “Ferytale” run of British wild card Arthur Fery with an overpowering 7-6 (0), 6-2, 6-4 victory in the semi-finals at the All England Club on Friday.

“This Grand Slam has always been the one that I



Alexander Zverev defeated local hope Arthur Fery in three sets

struggled with the most and all of a sudden I’m in the final of Wimbledon,” the 29-year-old German said. “We got one more match to go on Sunday and that’s what the focus is on.”

Zverev, whose breakthrough at Roland Garros came in his fourth Grand Slam final, is attempting to become the first man in the professional era (since 1968) to win his second title at the next event immediately

after his first Major trophy.

The 114th-ranked Fery, who grew up five minutes from the All England Club and played at Stanford University, was attempting to become the first wild card to reach the final since Goran Ivanisevic won Wimbledon in 2001.

“I think this was just the beginning of his career and I really think that he’s going to do amazing things in this sport,” Zverev said of Fery. AGENCIES



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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Kartik S/o Ishwar R/o H. No. RZB-126, Gali No. 4, Sitapuri Part-2, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 17224/22 U/s 379/411 IPC PS: Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kartik** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kartik** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Kartik** accused of **FIR No. 17224/22 U/s 379/411 IPC PS: Janakpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
JMFC-11 Room No. 05
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/9487/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Abishek @ Angrej S/o Inderjeet R/o H. No. 601, MCD Flat, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 747/2020 & 757/2020 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Abishek @ Angrej** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Abishek @ Angrej** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Abishek @ Angrej** of case **FIR No. 747/2020 & 757/2020 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 6
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9173/NW/2026 (Court Matter)



कार्यालय, कार्यपालन अभियंता,
लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकीय खण्ड,
मोहला-मानपुर-अं.चौकी(छ.ग.)

E-mail - renable-plr@ug.gov.in

// निविदा निरस्तीकरण सूचना //

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा, निविदा सूचना क्रमांक 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30 दिनांक 25-05-2026 सिरिस्टम क्रमांक 191562, 191564, 191565, 191566, 191567, 191568 (जी क्रमांक 262701001) तथा निविदा सूचना क्रमांक 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39 दिनांक 12-06-2026 सिरिस्टम क्रमांक 193318, 193319, 193320, 193321, 193322, 193323, 193324, 193325 (जी क्रमांक 262701437) में किसी निविदाकार द्वारा भाग नहीं लिये जाने के कारण निरस्त किया जाता है।

G 262702020/6

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Ezaz Ahmad S/o Quais Ahmed R/o F-11/11 Abul Fazal Enclave - 2 Shaheen Bagh Jamia Nagar Okhla Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 351/2023 U/s 287/338 BNS PS: IGI Airport, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ezaz Ahmad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ezaz Ahmad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ezaz Ahmad** accused of **FIR No. 351/2023 U/s 287/338 BNS PS: IGI Airport, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Pranav Joshi
DP/9323/IGIA/2026 ACJM-01, Room No. 02, Ground Floor
(Court Matter) Patiala House Court, New Delhi

कार्यालय अभियंता
लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकीय खण्ड,
मोहला-मानपुर-अं.चौकी(छ.ग.)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work.

Tender No.: AGCTRD/202618 **Approximate Cost:** Rs.1,18,30,997.36/-

Name of work: Annual maintenance contract of the PSI assets of Bhandai-Etawah section of Agra division for a period of Three years.

Earnest Money: Rs. 2,36,600/- **Period of completion:** Thirty Six months

1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 2. Tender can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" upto 15.00 Hrs. on date **03.08.2026**. 1575/26(K)

[North central railways](#) www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in [CPRONCR](#)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Yatin S/o Sunil R/o E-864, Village Khera, GTB Enclave, Shahdara, Delhi and E-864/13, GT Road, Near MS Park Metro, Village Khera, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 484/2019 U/s 323/341/427/325 IPC, P.S. GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Yatin** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Yatin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Yatin** of case **FIR No. 484/2019 U/s 323/341/427/325 IPC, P.S. GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 54, 2nd Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, New Delhi

DP/9476/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No:-DRM/C/AGRA/PARKING /E-AUCTION/2026 Date: 09.07.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category:	Auction Catalogue No.:
Parking	PARKING-AGC-2

Asset Details

(1) Agra Cant Railway Station - Towards 2nd Entry, Near Kheria Bridge/FCI Depo Two Wheelers Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date:- 24.07.2026 Time:- 12:00.

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date:- 24.07.2026 Time:- 12:30.

(2) Agra Cant Railway Station- Towards 2nd Entry, Near Kheria Bridge/FCI Depo - Mixed (Two Wheelers and Four Wheelers) Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date:- 24.07.2026 Time:- 12:00.

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date:- 24.07.2026 Time:- 12:40.

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1569/26 (MG)

[North central railways](#) [@CPRONCR](#) www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of work and its location	93-SRDEE/G-DLI-2026-27 Rewiring of Railway Quarters in the jurisdiction of SSE/PS/HNZM.
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 9429006.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 188600.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	31/07/2026, 16.00 Hrs
Opening of tender	31/07/2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.

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DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Shamsher Lal S/O Ghatti Ram R/O Chajartu Hira Nagar, Kathua is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 20/2011 U/S 221/304A RPC of P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Shamsher Lal
S/O	: Ghatti Ram
Address	: Chajartu Hira Nagar, Kathua
Age	: 38 years
Height	: 5'6"
Complexion	: Wheatish
Eyes	: Brown

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4.SP Rural Jammu	: 0191-2605949
5.SDPO Nagrota	: 0191-2673666
6.SHO P/S Nagrota	: 0191-2673025

Sd/-
For Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-5487/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jatin Sehgal, S/o Trilok Chand Sehgal, R/o D-3/2, DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni Dehat, Opp. Ram, Leela Maidan, Ghaziabad, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 269/2019, U/s 354D IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Jatin Sehgal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jatin Sehgal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jatin Sehgal** accused of **FIR No. 269/2019, U/s 354D IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.08.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Manya
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Mahila Court-02, Room No. 276, 2nd Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9360/N/2026



यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

प्रथम तल, कॉमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स, पी-2 सेक्टर-ओगोवा-1, ग्रेटर नोएडा, जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर-201308 (उ०प्र०)
टॉल फ्री नंबर : 18001808296, वेबसाइट : www.yamunaeexpresswayauthority.com

पत्रांक :- वाईईए/OSD(M)/2026/425 दिनांक: 08.07.2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्र सरकार/राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र शासित/अर्द्धशासित/सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों के कार्यों का कम से कम चार वर्ष का अनुभव रखने वाले ठेकेदारों/फर्मों से ई-निविदाएँ आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट सोल्यूशन द्वारा निविदाएँ डिस्ट्रीब्यूट पद्धति से खोली जायेगी।

कार्यालय आदेश संख्या: वाईईए/OSD(M)/2026/424 दिनांक 08.07.2026 के अनुपालन में यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के कार्यों में संविदाकार द्वारा यदि न्यूनतम दरदात (L1) द्वारा स्वीकृत बीओक्यू (BOQ) लागत से 10% तक कम दरें कोट की जाती हैं तो कोई अतिरिक्त परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी जमा नहीं करनी होगी। लेकिन यदि न्यूनतम दरदात द्वारा स्वीकृत बीओक्यू लागत से 10% से अधिक कम दरें कोट की जाती हैं तो 10% से अधिक जितना भी प्रतिशत कम दरें कोट की जाएगी, प्रत्येक 1% पर 1% की दर से अतिरिक्त सुख्खा / परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी जमा करानी होगी।

उक्त अतिरिक्त परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी अनुबंध के निष्पादन (प्रोमेंट करने) के समय ठेकेदार द्वारा जमा कराई जाएगी तथा परफॉर्मेंस गारंटी एफंडोआर / सीओडीआर / बैंक गारंटी / एनएएससीओ के रूप में न्यूनतम संविदाकार द्वारा अनुबंध गठन से पूर्व देनी होगी, जो कार्य के अंतिम बीजक होने के बाद वापिस होगी।

क्रम सं०	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सकिंल	अनुमानित लागत
1	Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of 11kv over head line for Existing point Village- Deorar to near Plont CESC Green Power Ltd. Sector-8D yea (WC-E&M-03)	रु० 19.35 लाख
2	Providing Street Light at Village - Sabota, Mustafabad yea (WC-E&M-02)	रु० 82.05 लाख
3	Construction of 11/415kv Substation in Sector- 20, Pocket-P yea (WC-E&M-02)	रु० 666.54 लाख
4	Construction of 11/0.415kv Substation in Sector-20, Pocket-G yea (WC-E&M-02)	रु० 577.97 लाख
5	Construction of 33/11kv Substation in Pocket-G (SS No.-04) Sector-20 yea (WC-E&M-02)	रु० 569.72 लाख

जिन्हें दिनांक 13.07.2026 से 27.07.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन दिनांक 29.07.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

निविदा प्रपत्र उत्तर प्रदेश इलेक्ट्रॉनिक्स कार्पोरेशन की वेबसाइट <http://e.tender.up.nic.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं। इच्छुक ठेकेदारों से अनुरोध है कि वे निम्नलिखित रूप से उक्त वेबसाइटों को देखते रहें, क्योंकि निविदाओं के समन्वय में कोई बदलाव अथवा अतिरिक्त सूचना वेबसाइट पर ही उपलब्ध करायी जायेगी।

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिस्थित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लान के अतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग/हाउसिंग/कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीद - फरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के ग्रामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaeexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
Jhajjar
1. Pawan S/o Smt. Ramkaur D/o Ram Swaroop
Vs.
1. Ram Niwas S/o Mohar Singh
CNR No. HRJRO2-000805-2024
Next Date 27-11-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
9. AVINASH S/O SURENDER
S/O RAMCHANDER
13.MEENA D/O SATBIR S/O RAMCHANDER 14 RAJBALA
D/O RAMCHANDER W/O MAHINDER 19.SHEELA D/O MEER SINGH 21. LAXMI
D/O MEER SINGH R/O ALL VILLAGE SEHLANGA, TEHSIL MATANHAIL AND DISTRICT JHAJJAR
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **27-11-2026 at 10:00 a.m.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district%20Notice&district=Jhajjar>
Sd/-Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
date 09-07-2026 Jhajjar



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E-mail: spkathua@jkpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 04-07-2026, one person namely Balbir Kumar S/O Hans Raj R/O Ward No. 17 near Police Line Kathua Tehsil and District Kathua lodged a written report at Police Station Kathua stating therein that on 04-07-2026 at about 1200 hrs his daughter namely Nishu Devi, age 24 years went missing from home. The complainant and his family members tried their best to search for her but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 22 dated 04-07-2026 has been entered at Police Station Kathua.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

DESCRIPTION ROLL	PHOTOGRAPH
• Name : Nishu Devi • Father : Balbir Kumar • Permanent Address : Ward No. 17 near Police Line • Present Address : Ward No. 17 near Police Line • Tehsil : Kathua • Police Station : Kathua • Age : 24 years • Height : 5 feet 3 inch • Complexion : Fair • Build : Normal • Face : Round • Eyes : Black • Languages known : Hindi/ Dogri	

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Kathua - 01922-234310, 9103007509

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

DIP No:DIP/J-5513/26



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Shabir Ahmed S/O Abdul Rasheed R/O Churath Bhatpora Qazikund Tehsil and district Kulgam is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 142/2011 U/S 188 RPC, 3/181 MV Act P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Shabir Ahmed
S/O	: Abdul Rasheed
Address	: Churath Bhatpora Qazikund Tehsil and district Kulgam
Age	: 38 years
Height	: 5'6"
Complexion	: Wheatish
Eyes	: Brown

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4.SP Rural Jammu	: 0191-2605949
5.SDPO Nagrota	: 0191-2673666
6.SHO P/S Nagrota	: 0191-2673025

Sd/-
For Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-5525/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Dinesh Kumar S/O. Lt. Sh. Birju Prasad R/o D-1, Tibbia Collage Karol Bagh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.12/2022 at PS: Karol Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Dinesh Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Dinesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Dinesh Kumar of FIR No. 12/2022 of PS: Karol Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 02.09.2026.**

By order
Nishat Bangarh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
(Central) Room No. 180
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8534/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ajay Kumar, S/o: Om Prakash, R/o: H.No-B-3, Sapera Basti, Ghazipur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 506/2021, U/s: 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ajay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ajay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ajay Kumar of P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Central, Room No. 138,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9396/N/2026



Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodara- 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Shal Tower Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road Karol Bagh New Delhi- 110005

Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower
PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Home Loan LBDEL00002044703 (Credit facility) was granted to SAROJ KUMARI OF BORROWER, Co-Borrower, Guarantor/Mortgagor (excluding deceased borrower) (Borrowers) along with the deceased MR. ARUN KUMAR RAM by ICICI Bank Ltd. (The Bank).

We would like to inform you that the demise of MR. ARUN KUMAR RAM has come to our knowledge during field visits conducted by the Bank officials and by telephonic communications on the registered contact numbers. In this regard, letter dated 09 July,2026 was previously sent to the registered addresses of the Borrowers and the deceased MR. ARUN KUMAR RAM, for providing information about the Legal Heirs of the deceased Borrower.

Therefore, this Notice is hereby given for sharing details of the Legal Heirs of the deceased MR. ARUN KUMAR SINGH with supporting documents for updating the Bank's records, within 15 days of publication of this Notice.

You may submit the above-mentioned details to Mr. MANPREET SINGH by visiting Address: ICICI BANK LTD PLOT NO. 7, COMMUNITY CENTRE S.D. TOWER, SECTOR 8, ROHINI, NEW DELHI - 110085.

Date: July 11, 2026
Place: Delhi/ NCR

Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd,

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

Description	N.L.T.	17.8-19-2026-27-WV
1. Name of work with its location	17	Provision of VIP lounge by merging existing old vacant panel room & yard master room and Ladies waiting room in vacant CTNC office room and improvement of ating area by providing shed and seating arrangement for passengers at DEE Station in the section of SSE/W/DEE under ADEN/DEE. Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work other than track work
	19	Improvement to water quality by providing commercial RO system at Faridabad Station along with two years AMC in the section of SSE/W/FDB under ADEN/TKD. Similar nature of work:- Providing and maintaining R.O/Softening plants/ filtration plants.
2. Approx. Cost of work	17	Rs. 11299987.94
	19	Rs. 8499849.08
3. Earnest Money Deposit: (It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no 201025/CE-IC/T/5/1 dated 31.08.2016)	17	Rs. 226000.00
	19	Rs. 170000.00
4. Completion period of Work	17	06 Months
	19	24 Months
5. Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender: Upto 15.00 hrs on 03.08.2026 Opening of tender at 15.00 hrs. on 03.08.2026		
6. Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in		
No. 128-W/2026/OET/2026-27/W-V/INT-17 & 19-2026-27 Date 08.07.26		
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2361/2026		



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, North Central Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-GSU-2026-06 **Approx Cost (Rs.):** 43495361.53

Description of work: Fabrication and supply of RH Girder (RDSO) with Bearing Girds (RDSO) in connection with Construction of RUBS in lieu of LC Nos. 383, 384, 386, 390, 414, 417 & 418 in JHS-MKP section of Jhansi Division, North Central Railway.

Earnest Money (Rs.): 869900.00 **Date of closing Tender:** 30.07.2026

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 06 month

Tender online can be submitted upto to 10:30 hrs. on 30.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1567/26(K)

[North central railways](#) www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in [CPRONCR](#)



PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION SCO NO.74-75, BANK SQUARE, SECTOR 17-B, CHANDIGARH Ph: 0172-5197882; 0172-5197880; 5197889 Web: www.pswc.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

(Through Govt. of Punjab e-Tender Portal - <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>)
REFERENCE NO. PSWC/CFS/LDH/ Workshop/2026-27/01
Punjab State Warehousing Corporation (PSWC) invites e-tenders by way of single stage, two cover system from experienced and professional organizations to "Operate workshop for repair, maintenance and allied services of Empty ISO exim cargo containers" in open and covered spaces at its Container Freight Station (CFS), A-12, Phase V, Focal Point, Dhandari Kalan (DDL), Ludhiana on "as is where is basis".
Closing Date and Time: Upto 15:00 Hours on 03.08.2026
For details log on to: <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
Note: This notice is also available at www.pswc.in. Any corrigendum to the e-Tender Notice shall be published on above website (eproc.punjab.gov.in) and www.pswc.in.
PR-Advt. No :- 1004/12/2026-27/13110 **Managing Director**



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: PU-AGC-ST-MSDAC-T01-2026 **Date:** 09.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE (Two Packet)

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Proj, Agra Cantt, North Central Railway for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-Tender from reputed contractors/JV firms with adequate experience and financial capability, for the following work on Two Packet System up to 15.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned

YOUNG PEOPLE MISS THE SOLIDITY OF OLDER LOVE: IMTIAZ ALI

As ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’ finds its audience, the director discusses hope, love and Partition



ANINDITA ACHARYA

At a time when aggressive promotion has become the order of the day, director Imtiaz Ali’s ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’ has chosen to place its faith in the audience. After a slow start following its June 12 release, the film, which is about hope in an age of despair, has been steadily improving its box-office numbers.

The ‘Jab We Met’ director, known for making some of Hindi cinema’s finest love stories, is now travelling across the country to connect with audiences. On Thursday, he made a stop in Kolkata, a city he calls his ‘favourite’ in the country. He has friends and relatives here, knows the best places to eat (and often visits the city just for that) and cherishes the memories preserved in its old buildings.

Imtiaz’s films are often emotional journeys with narratives that explore heartache and the search for meaning. ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’ brings together all those elements against the backdrop of Partition, one of history’s greatest tragedies. On a rain-soaked morning over coffee in Kolkata, Imtiaz speaks to ‘Millennium Post’ about why he felt an urgency to tell a story about Partition, his idea of love in modern times and more.

Many filmmakers today are making darker, grittier films. You were dealing with one of history’s greatest tragedies, Partition, in ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’. Most Partition films focus on violence and hatred. You deliberately chose tenderness, longing and hope instead. Was it important for you to reclaim Partition through human memories rather than political narratives? Yes. I feel that all the stories

Of Loneliness, Love & More

You have often spoken about love, but your films are equally about loneliness. Do you think loneliness is the defining emotional condition of contemporary life?

Well, in ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’, what I have learnt about loneliness is that you can deal with it by having love in your heart. There is a poem that goes, ‘Tum mere paas hote ho goya/ Jab koi doosra nahi hota’. This is what it is. What is in your heart becomes your constant companion.

In your films, be it ‘Tamasha’, ‘Jab We Met’ or ‘Love Aaj Kal’, your characters often find clarity only after they leave familiar surroundings. Do you believe travel is essential not just for personal growth but also for you as a filmmaker?

Travel is unmistakably one of the most important factors in my life and I believe it is in many people’s lives too.

It’s been 15 years since you shot ‘Love Aaj Kal’ with



Saif Ali Khan in Kolkata. Do you have plans to come back to Kolkata to shoot? The colour palette of the city has changed a lot.

(Cuts in) I will come back to Kolkata to shoot not for what has changed but for what has remained unchanged. It’s the memories, the nostalgia and the beauty of the buildings in Kolkata that attract me to this City of Joy. Kolkata is the most artistic and most beautiful city in the country. It’s definitely my favourite city in the country. So, I hope I keep coming back again and again.

that come to my mind are personal... All the stories that I have heard about Partition are personal. I have met countless people who witnessed Partition and have told me the stories they saw with their own eyes. All those stories are personal. After meeting them, I got this idea that there is a side of the story of Partition that is missing. It’s the human side of love and I thought that this was priceless and should be told. I also wanted to tell the story quickly before this last generation passes away.

So, you felt a sense of urgency to tell this story before those memories were lost forever?

Yes. This generation that witnessed Partition is disappearing. We must acknowledge what they saw, heard and the pain they endured. And then, we can learn from the lesson of love they have

tried to teach us.

So, was it during the shooting of ‘Amar Singh Chamkila’ that you heard these stories of Partition in Punjab?

Well, living in India, one can hardly avoid hearing stories of Partition. I am from Jamshedpur. I have also heard stories about Partition. When I was in Delhi, I visited Punjab for many of my films and almost everyone I met had some history or story to tell about Partition.

Punjab has almost become a recurring character in your cinema, from ‘Rockstar’ to ‘Love Aaj Kal’, ‘Amar Singh Chamkila’ and now ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’. What keeps drawing you back to its people and emotional landscape?

I am not so sure about this, but I feel a certain sense of belonging there. I feel a certain excitement

when I am there. I feel I can see stories in Punjab and relate to them. I feel like amplifying those stories and when I return to shoot in Punjab, I discover more things. Then I want to make more films there. So, it’s like a cycle.

Migration is perhaps the defining story of the 21st century, from refugees to climate displacement to economic migration. Was ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’ your way of connecting the trauma of 1947 with what the world is witnessing today?

(Cuts in) Absolutely, 100 per cent. I was focusing more on man-made trauma and Partition in ‘Main Vaapas Aaunga’. I wanted to liken it to all the tragic incidents that are happening across the world today. It’s like if you forget history, you are condemned to repeat it.

This is also a story of immortal love

“This generation that witnessed Partition is disappearing. We must acknowledge what they saw, heard and the pain they endured”

in a commitment-phobic world. Do you think younger audiences, living in the age of dating apps and instant connections, are still drawn to old-fashioned love stories? Has your idea of love evolved over time?

The young people are connecting more to the film because they miss the solidity of the love of the older generation. It’s exactly what happens in the film between Diljit Dosanjh’s and Naseeruddin Shah’s characters as grandson and grandfather. Diljit misses the kind of love that Naseer has in his life. He wishes he had the kind of love that Naseer carries in his heart. That is exactly what the younger generation feels when they are watching the film.

This is your first collaboration with Naseeruddin Shah. Was it easy directing the legend?

Yes, it was easy. Actually, he is just Naseeruddin Shah, but he behaves like a young actor. He is extremely enthusiastic and quite demanding. He is fully involved at the set and expects that same involvement from everybody. That is obvious. I think there was very good synergy between Naseer, the unit and me. He remains our favourite actor in this film. The unit also loves him more than they love the other actors.

Celebrating legendary artist Josep Renau

The exhibition will be open for viewing on July 16, 2026, at 6:30 pm

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The Embassy of Mexico in India, in collaboration with the Instituto Cervantes - Nueva Delhi, is pleased to announce the opening of the exhibition ‘Mexican Film Posters: The Golden Age of Cinema through the work of Josep Renau 1940-1958’, on July 16, 2026, at 6:30 pm at Instituto Cervantes New Delhi.

Film posters in Mexico emerged alongside the transformation of cinema into mass entertainment. Early single-ink street posters evolved rapidly with the release of Mexico’s first sound film, ‘Santa’ (1931). From this moment, cinema became a powerful platform for cultural nationalism and music, creating icons that defined the nation’s ‘Golden Age’. Posters from this period often reflected the cultural nationalism and costumbrismo of Mexican cinema: mariachis, revolutionary figures, rural women and archetypal characters that shaped a collective national imagination.

This unique exhibition celebrates the visionary designs of Josep Renau, the legendary Spanish artist and political exile, while exploring how film posters transcended their



original purpose as simple advertisements to become striking works of art that defined an entire cultural era throughout the mid-20th century.

Featuring historically significant posters preserved by Mexico’s General Archives of the Nation (Archivo General de la Nación), the exhibition brings together remarkable film publicity materials created between 1940 and 1958, a period that corresponds to the Golden Age of Mexican cinema, including classics such as Ahí está el detalle, Allá en el Rancho

An exhibition of iconic Mexican film posters, celebrating the graphic legacy of the Spanish artist, is on display at the Instituto Cervantes, New Delhi

Grande and Ensayo de un crimen. Through a compelling selection of 88 iconic film posters, visitors will discover how Renau combined photomontage, offset printing and bold graphic design to shape the identity of an unforgettable era in the history of Mexican cinema. This exhibition invites art enthusiasts, film lovers and the public to celebrate the timeless intersection of cinema, graphic design and cultural heritage through one of the most fascinating visual legacies of the 20th century. ‘Mexican Film Posters: The Golden Age of Cinema through the work of Josep Renau 1940-1958’ will remain on display daily, 11 am to 8 pm, until September 18, 2026, at the Instituto Cervantes - Nueva Delhi.

79TH LOCARNO FILM FESTIVAL

Naseeruddin Shah’s ‘Rehmat’ is India’s lone contender

OUR CORRESPONDENT

National Award-winning filmmaker Gurvinder Singh’s latest feature, ‘Rehmat’, will have its world premiere in the Concorso Internazionale (Main Competition) at the 79th Locarno Film Festival, to be held from August 5-15, 2026, in Locarno, Switzerland.

‘Rehmat’ is the only Indian feature film selected for this year’s edition. The film will compete for the festival’s highest honour, the Pardo d’Oro (Golden Leopard). ‘Rehmat’ features an acclaimed ensemble led by Naseeruddin Shah, Suvinder Vicky, Mita Vashisht, Navjot Randhawa and Anita Meet, alongside newcomers Diya Kamboj, Harwinder Aujla and Jaswant Zafar. Based on the short stories of celebrated Punjabi writer Ajeet Cour, the film has been jointly produced by her daughter, eminent artist Arpana Caur and Singh.

Alongside the main competition, ‘Rehmat’ has also been nominated for the Pardo for Change, a special award recognising films that engage with pressing environmental, ethical, social and cultural issues. Selected



This is Gurvinder Singh’s fourth feature, adapted from Punjabi literature

from across the festival programme, 13 feature films will compete for the honour, which carries a prize of CHF 20,000 for the winning director.

Widely regarded as one of India’s most distinctive contemporary filmmakers, Singh has made earlier films including ‘Anhey Ghorhey Da Daan’, ‘Chauthi Koot’ and ‘Adh Chananai Raat’.

‘We don’t have to be airbrushed just to show up’

Hollywood star Jennifer Garner said she never tries to present a perfect image on social media



Hollywood star Jennifer Garner feels lucky to have a ‘lovely life’, but the actress, popular for romantic comedies like ‘13 Going on 30’, ‘Ghosts of Girlfriends Past’ and ‘Valentine’s Day’, said she never tries to present a perfect image on social media.

Garner said she leads a normal life and encourages others to do the same.

“Look, I don’t post on ‘Instagram’ very often, maybe once or twice a week. But when I do, I definitely am usually not in makeup. I usually am in whatever I happen to be wearing. And granted, I do live a lovely life and I’m very lucky that way. But I try to take perfection out of it. I’m not a perfect cook and yet I love to cook. So, in my own quiet way, I’m trying to just encourage that side of other women and feel like we don’t have to be airbrushed just to be, just to show up for each other,” Garner told PTI in a virtual interview from Los Angeles.

The actress now stars in ‘The Five-Star Weekend’, an adaptation of Elin Hilderbrand’s novel of the same name that will see her play a celebrity as a food influencer. Hilderbrand’s ‘The Perfect Couple’ was recently adapted by ‘Netflix’. In ‘The Five-Star Weekend’, Garner’s Hollis Shaw invites her girlfriends from different decades of her life as a way to process her grief after the sudden death of her husband.

Garner said she was looking for something interesting and complicated when she found Hilderbrand’s 2023 novel and instantly connected with its story.

“I love Elin Hilderbrand’s writing. I loved this particular novel. I was surprised by it as I read it all the way through from beginning to end. I love Bekah Brunstetter, who is our showrunner. I loved her adaptation. She’s a playwright. She has a deft hand. She’s gifted at character, at comedy, at drama, all of it,” she said.

AGENCIES



Garner said she leads a normal life and encourages others to do the same

First look: The India Story

The makers of ‘The India Story’ have unveiled a gripping poster that further builds anticipation for the upcoming socially relevant courtroom drama. Directed by Chetnan DK, the film is inspired by the issue of pesticide farming and its far-reaching impact on public health.

The newly released poster features Kajal Aggarwal and Shreyas Talpade in a tense and emotionally charged moment. The film releases on July 24.

